CLARK FARM · 9600 SR-72, SARASOTA

Agriculture Education Center

Beginning Farmer and 4-H Youth Agriculture Complex.
Master plan study for stakeholder review.

Stakeholder review
October 21, 2026 · 5:30 pm
Extension Green Room

Seibert Architects
Project 2601

Draft
for discussion



WHY WE'RE HERE

From the Owner's goals to design drivers

Four goals do most of the work in shaping this plan.



Pasture is scarce

Available pasture is what this community is short on. So the land sets the size of the herd, not the other way around.

DRIVES: HERD SIZE, FENCING



Reuse first

The Red House and the existing barns go back to work before anything new is built, keeping the site's Old Florida character.

DRIVES: WHAT WE KEEP



Grow by module

Pens and barns are added in modules as programs fill up, first come, first served. Nothing is locked to a fixed animal count.

DRIVES: HOW IT GROWS



Protect the water

The site drains to Cowpen Slough. Grazing, washdown, and manure are planned around water quality from the start.

DRIVES: LAYOUT, TIMING

WHY WE'RE HERE

One plan, three Levels

The study is organized in three Levels of investment. Every part of the plan is shown at each one. The site work is not phased: permitting, stormwater, and floodplain compensation are all done at Level 1, and the Levels phase what is built inside it.

LEVEL 1 Lightest touch

The least it takes to open and operate. Every existing building is reused with minimum renovation.

OPEN THE DOORS

LEVEL 2 Better management

The same land, managed harder, with the first new buildings as programs fill up.

GROW WITH DEMAND

LEVEL 3 Best case

The full program on all the pasture available, bonus land included.

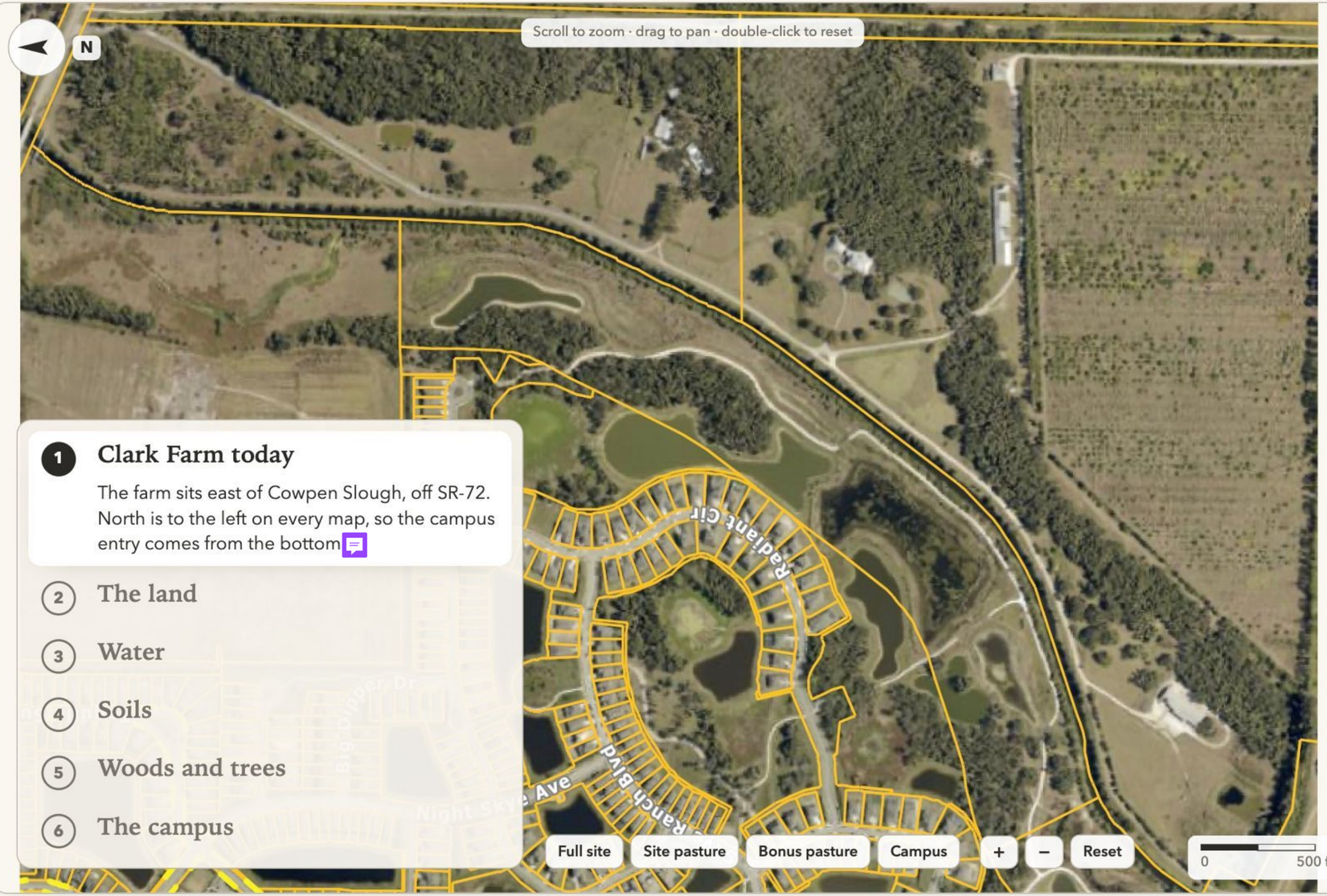
THE CEILING WE PLAN TO

← We designed Level 3 first, then worked back to Level 1, so each Level builds on the one before it.

THE APPROACH

The land sets the herd, the programs set the buildings, and the Levels let it grow.

Clark Farm, layer by layer



Aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser; tree canopy is traced from it. Survey, soils, trees, and fencing: Seibert Architects CAD sheets, aligned by matching their geometry. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions; confirm in Web Soil Survey.

Clark Farm, layer by layer



1. **Clark Farm today**
2. **The land**

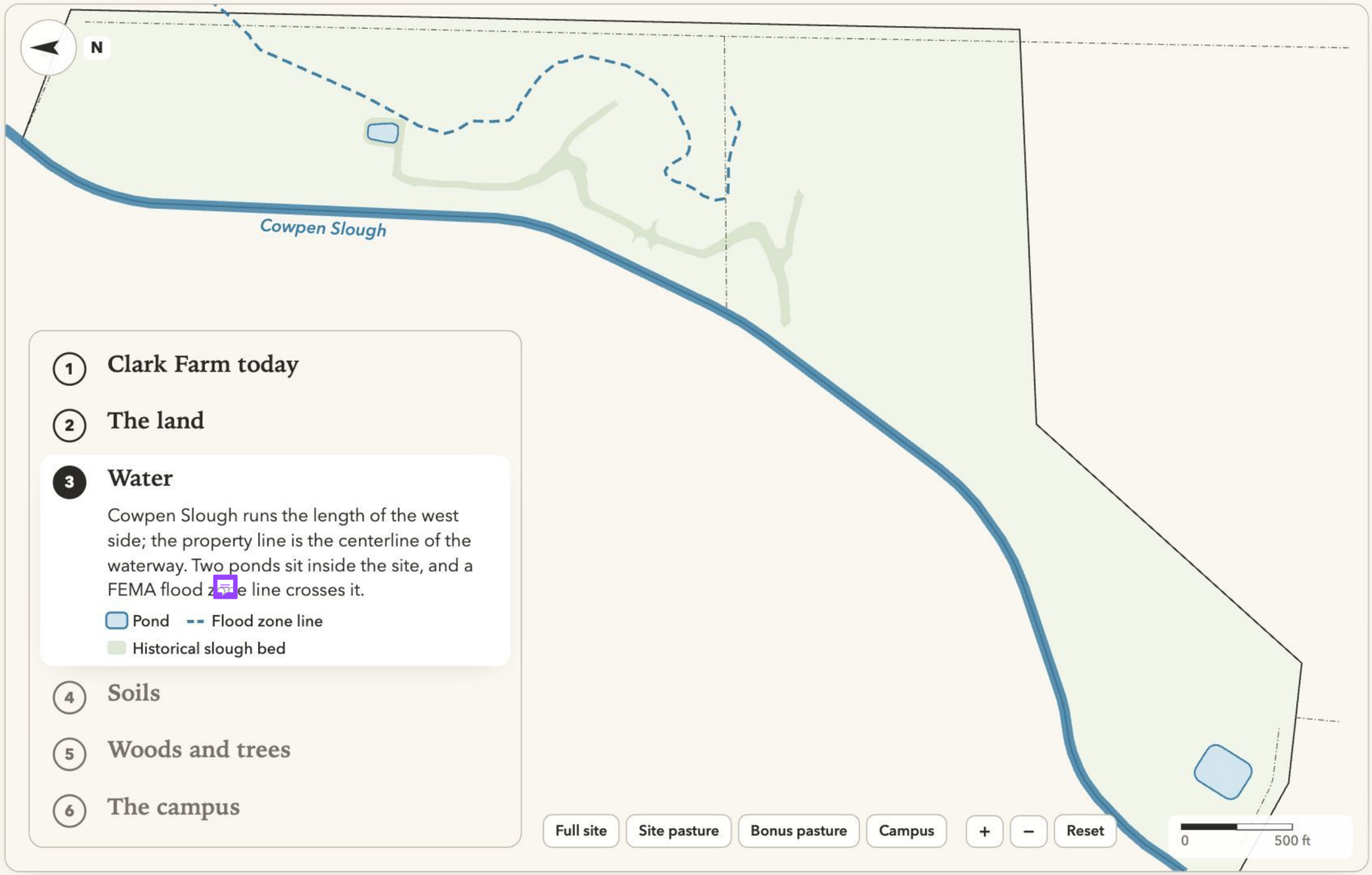
   About 100 acres of potential pasture: 45.3 on the site and 54.5 of bonus land beside it. Pasture is what this community is short on. The site line was drawn somewhat arbitrarily by the County's Solid Waste department, which controls the land and is open to IFAS using more of it: that is the bonus pasture.

   Site pasture Bonus pasture
3. **Water**
4. **Soils**
5. **Woods and trees**
6. **The campus**

99.8
acres of potential pasture

Aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser; tree canopy is traced from it. Survey, soils, trees, and fencing: Seibert Architects CAD sheets, aligned by matching their geometry. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions; confirm in Web Soil Survey.

Clark Farm, layer by layer



1. **Clark Farm today**
2. **The land**
3. **Water**

   Cowpen Slough runs the length of the west side; the property line is the centerline of the waterway. Two ponds sit inside the site, and a FEMA flood zone line crosses it.

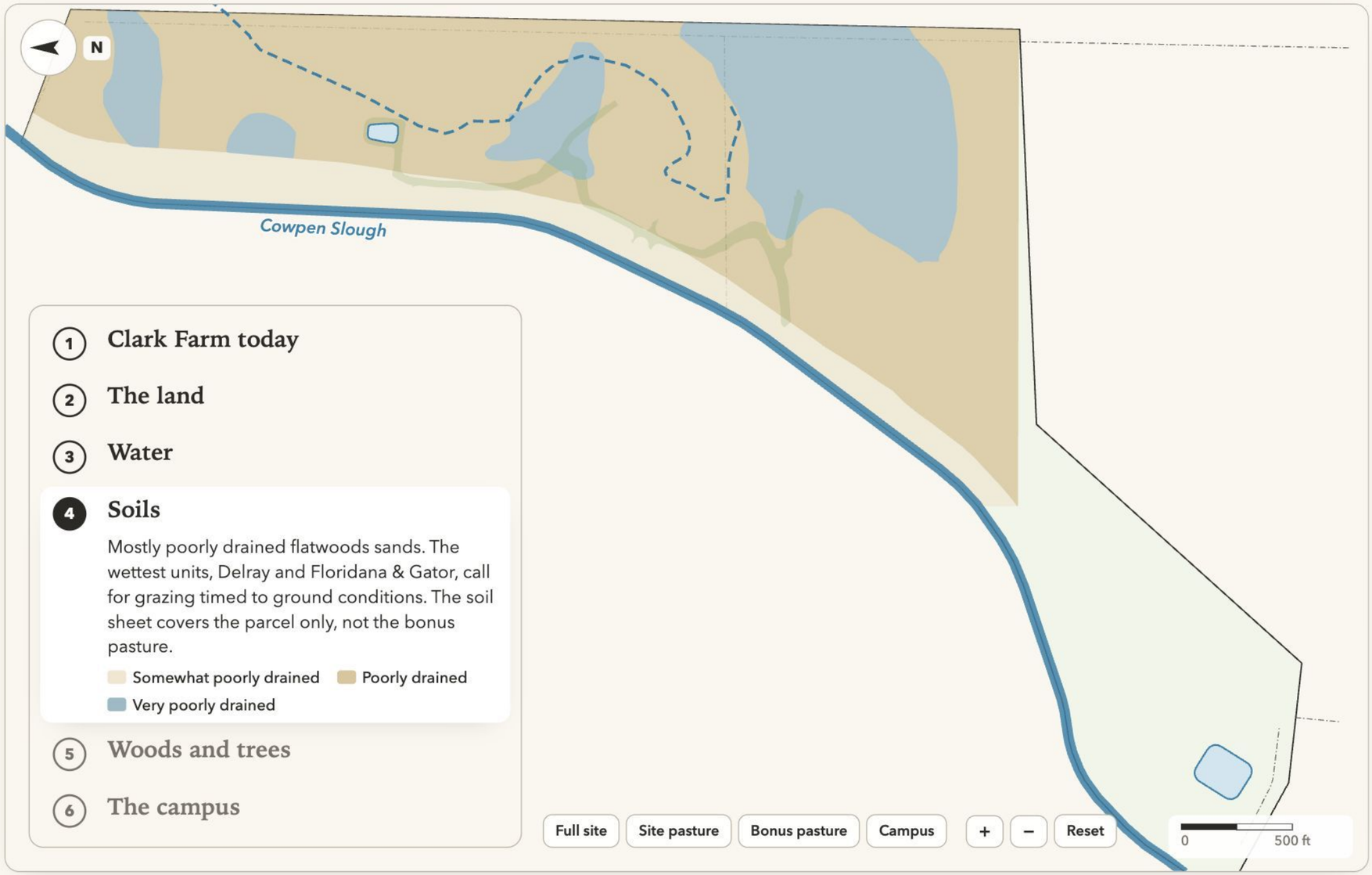
   Pond · Flood zone line · Historical slough bed
4. **Soils**
5. **Woods and trees**
6. **The campus**

99.8
acres of potential pasture

2
ponds inside the site, beside Cowpen Slough

Aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser; tree canopy is traced from it. Survey, soils, trees, and fencing: Seibert Architects CAD sheets, aligned by matching their geometry. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions; confirm in Web Soil Survey.

Clark Farm, layer by layer



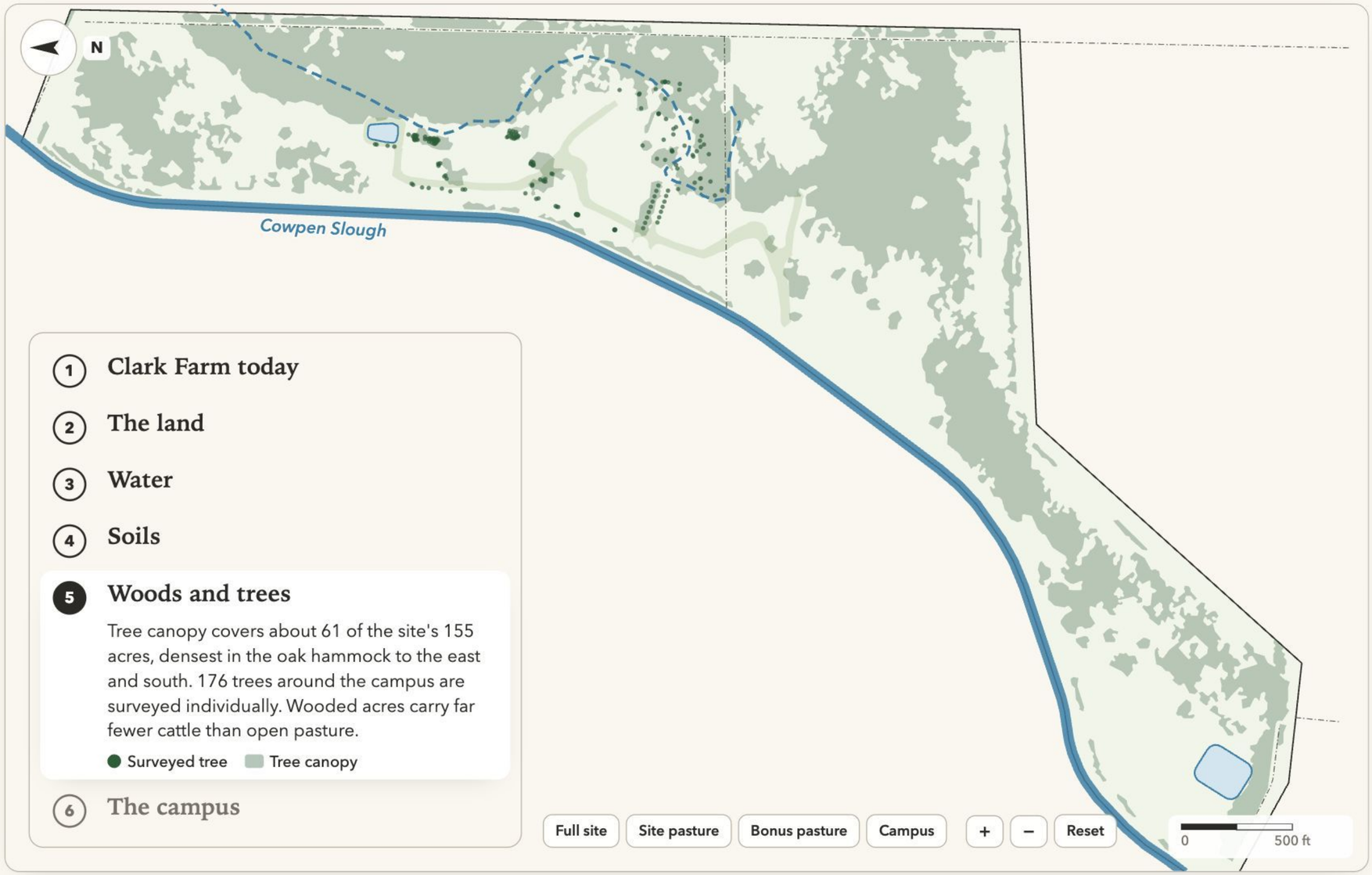
99.8
acres of potential pasture

2
ponds inside the site, beside Cowpen Slough

24%
of the mapped site is very poorly drained

Aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser; tree canopy is traced from it. Survey, soils, trees, and fencing: Seibert Architects CAD sheets, aligned by matching their geometry. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions; confirm in Web Soil Survey.

Clark Farm, layer by layer



1. **Clark Farm today**
2. **The land**
3. **Water**
4. **Soils**
5. **Woods and trees**

   Tree canopy covers about 61 of the site's 155 acres, densest in the oak hammock to the east and south. 176 trees around the campus are surveyed individually. Wooded acres carry far fewer cattle than open pasture.

   ● Surveyed tree ▭ Tree canopy
6. **The campus**

Full site | Site pasture | Bonus pasture | Campus | + | − | Reset

99.8
acres of potential pasture

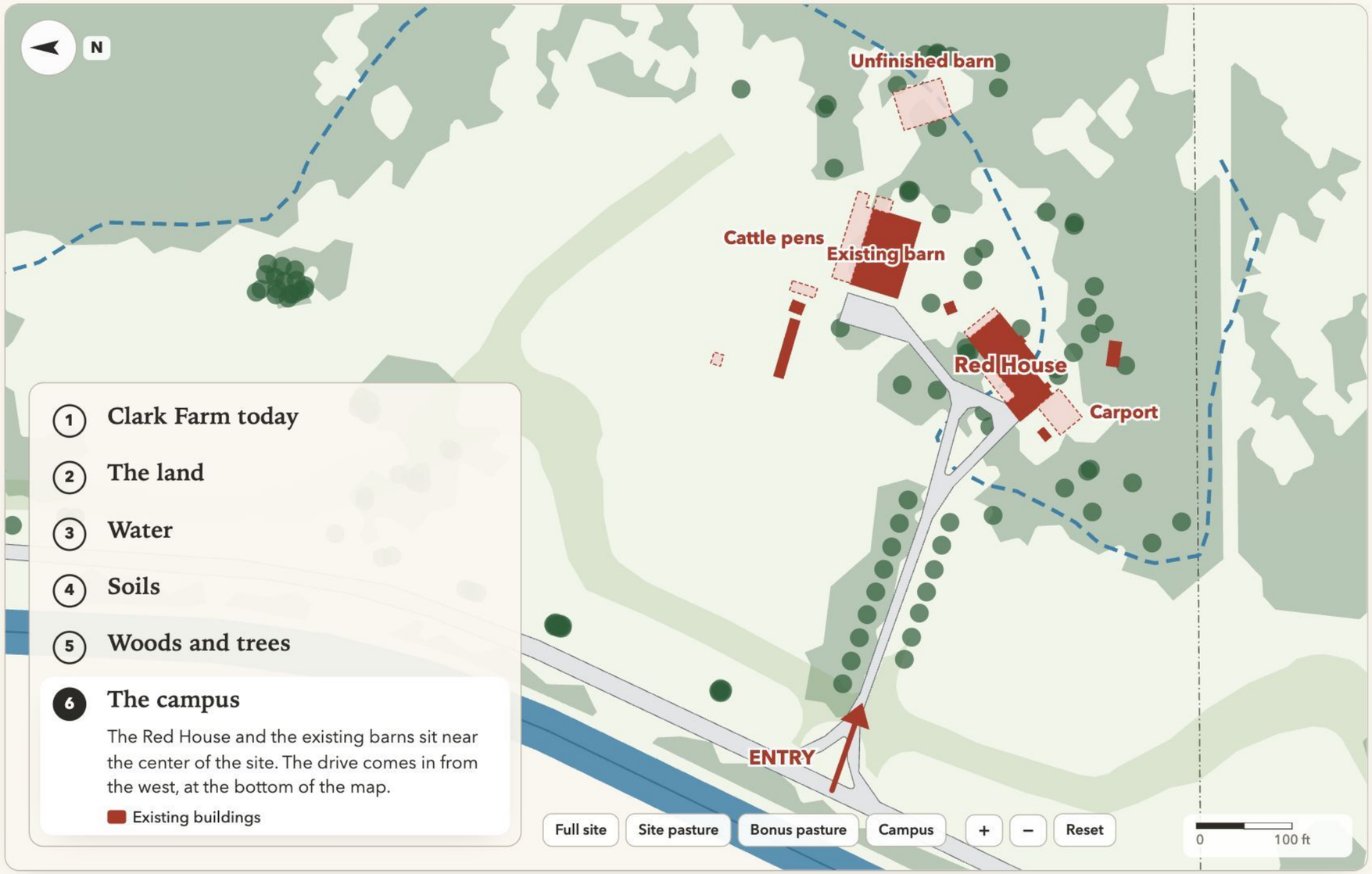
2
ponds inside the site, beside Cowpen Slough

24%
of the mapped site is very poorly drained

39%
of the site under tree canopy

Aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser; tree canopy is traced from it. Survey, soils, trees, and fencing: Seibert Architects CAD sheets, aligned by matching their geometry. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions; confirm in Web Soil Survey.

Clark Farm, layer by layer



99.8
acres of potential pasture

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of the mapped site is very poorly drained

39%
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Aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser; tree canopy is traced from it. Survey, soils, trees, and fencing: Seibert Architects CAD sheets, aligned by matching their geometry. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions; confirm in Web Soil Survey.

What is already built

Six existing structures, all near the center of the site.



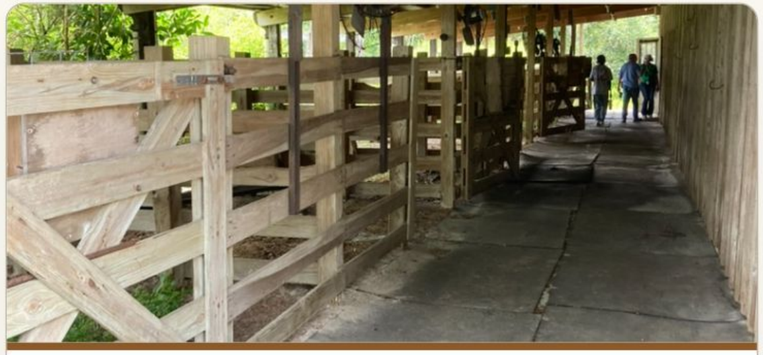
The Red House

Former residence under the oaks, with several floor levels and wraparound porches.



Existing barn

Wood-sided barn with four roll-up doors and a concrete apron.



Seven cattle pens

Timber pens along a covered aisle with fans overhead, on the east side of the existing barn.



Hog enclosures

Long open-sided timber shed, out in the pasture.



Small unfinished barns

Open timber frames with new metal roofs, not yet served by power or water.



Squeeze chute

A chute and gates in a small holding pen, for working pasture cattle.

Two cattle programs, more animals, and people

Each user of the farm needs something different from it.

ANIMALS

Beginning Rancher herd

Lives on **pasture**. No pens. Needs fencing, water, and a corral with chute and scale for working the herd.

4-H cow & calf projects

Housed in **12' × 24' pens**, one project per pen, with turnout, washdown, and feed and tack storage.

Swine, sheep, and goats

Shaded, well-ventilated small-animal pens on a **6' × 10'** module, sturdy enough for hogs and easy to clean out. Any pen can take any of the three.

Poultry

Predator-safe poultry housing, apart from the other animals.

PEOPLE

Teaching

A classroom and workshop for **about 50**, and a demonstration kitchen.

Meeting

A conference room for **20 to 25**, near the lobby and restrooms.

Staff

Offices for **5 staff**, with sight of the entry.

Growing

A small horticulture teaching area.

Showing

Space for demonstrations, turnout, and community events.

GROUND RULES

Animal care standard

The Ag Guide (4th ed.) sets the bar for space, water, shade, ventilation, and handling.

Modular and flexible

Pens, panels, and gates that can be rearranged as demand changes.

Safe separation

Public, staff, animal-care, and service areas kept distinct, with supervised access for youth.

Water quality first

Stormwater, washdown, and manure handled so nothing runs unmanaged to the slough

Pasture-based cattle capacity

Mature-cow equivalents (CE) the fenced pasture can carry at each investment Level. Level 3 is the best case. Level 1 is the minimum needed to operate.

LEVEL 1 Minimum to operate

45.3 ac fenced site pasture



25 open · 20.3 wooded

Conservative management

25 ac open ÷ 4 ac/CE = 6.2 CE
20.3 ac wooded ÷ 25 ac/CE = 0.8 CE

≈ 7 CE — 7.1 calculated



+ BETTER MANAGEMENT

LEVEL 2 Better management

45.3 ac fenced site pasture



25 open · 20.3 wooded

Improved rotational grazing

25 ac open ÷ 2 ac/CE = 12.5 CE
20.3 ac wooded ÷ 10 ac/CE = 2 CE

≈ 15 CE — 14.5 calculated



+ BONUS PASTURE

LEVEL 3 Best case

99.8 ac fenced site + bonus pasture



44.1 open · 55.7 wooded · bonus land

Improved rotational grazing

44.1 ac open ÷ 2 ac/CE = 22 CE
55.7 ac wooded ÷ 10 ac/CE = 5.6 CE

≈ 28 CE — 27.6 calculated



CE is mature-cow-equivalent grazing demand. The pasture herd belongs to the **Beginning Rancher** program. **4-H cow & calf projects** are housed in 12'×24' pens and sized separately. Head count may be higher where cattle are lighter, but the final number should be set from expected animal weights and forage demand.

Stocking rates: UF/IFAS AN155 planning values (conservative 4 ac/CE open, 25 ac/CE wooded; improved rotational 2 and 10), to be refined with UF/IFAS for forage condition and animal type. Acreages: fencing plan A0.1 and the pasture worksheet.

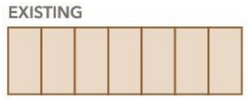
GROW BY MODULE

Pens grow with 4-H demand

The Beginning Rancher herd lives on pasture. 4-H cow & calf projects get pens, added in 7-pen modules as enrollment grows.

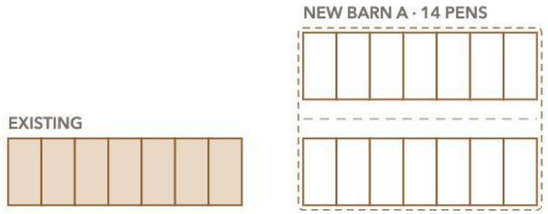
Yes, we are putting cow pens on Cow Pen Slough.
We didn't name it. We're just following directions.

LEVEL 1
Lightest touch



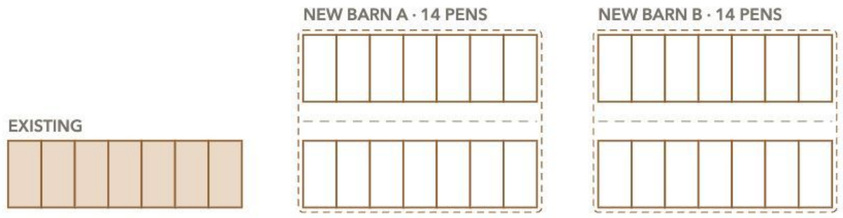
7 pens
existing horse barn

LEVEL 2
Better management



21 pens
7 existing + 14 new

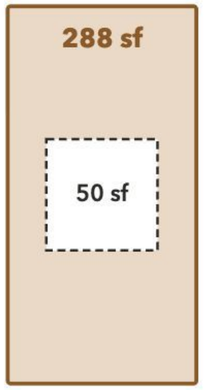
LEVEL 3
Best case



35 pens
7 existing + 28 new

Existing pen New pen, 12' × 24' All plans at the same scale

Why 12' × 24'



≈ 6×
the commercial minimum. The Ag Guide calls for 35–50 sf per 1,000–1,300 lb cow in an enclosed, bedded barn.

Room to stand, lie, groom, and halter-train, with space for youth working alongside. The module comes from a previous educational barn, by Owner direction.

The 7-pen module

Each new barn is **14 pens**: two 7-pen rows facing a tractor aisle. The second barn is built only when demand fills the first.

Keeping barns to 14 pens is intended to stay within fire-code area limits; this will be confirmed with the AHJ. 14' tractor aisle, as at the previous educational barn. Ag Guide 4th ed., Table 6-1.

One barn for swine, sheep, and goats

One kind of pen for all three. The hogs move into the existing barn at Level 1, swap into a new barn at Level 2, and that barn grows south at Level 3.

LEVEL 1

Lightest touch

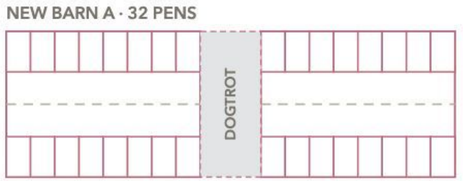


≈32 pens

in the existing barn; the 10 old hog pens give way to the Level 1 site improvements

LEVEL 2

Better management

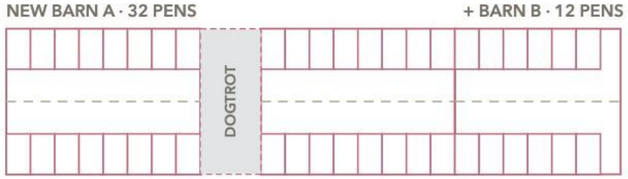


32 pens

a clean swap: the existing barn becomes storage

LEVEL 3

Best case



44 pens

32 in A + 12 in B

Existing New pen, 6' × 10' All plans at the same scale

The 6' × 10' pen

60 sf
6' × 10'

16

pens to a wing: two rows of 6' × 10' pens facing a 16' aisle, in a 36'-wide barn.

Any pen can take a hog, a sheep, or a goat, so the mix can follow enrollment from year to year.

One barn, two steps

Barn A is **two wings with a roofed dogtrot** between them, opening to its turnout on the west. Barn B extends it south, as far as the fire code allows for one building.

Barns A and B together are about 5,472 sf, under the 5,500 sf limit for a one-storey Group U, Type VB building (IBC Table 506.2); to be confirmed with the AHJ.

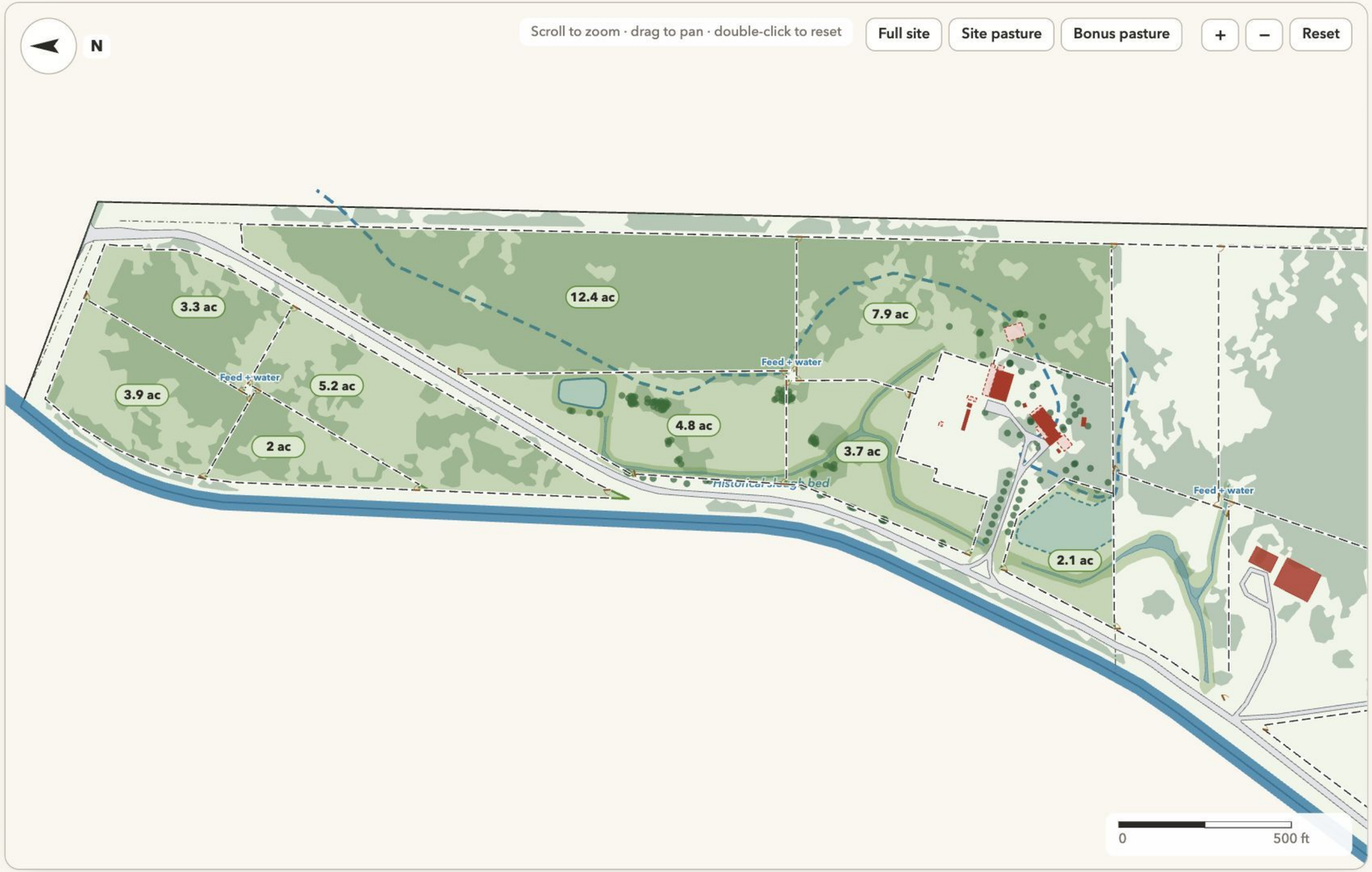
What each Level buys

Planned from the best case down. Level 1 is the lightest touch that meets the program, and each Level above adds facilities as funding and demand allow.

	LEVEL 1 **Lightest touch** Reuse every existing building with minimum renovation	LEVEL 2 **Better management** Rotational grazing and first new facilities	LEVEL 3 **Best case** Full program, sized to best-case pasture capacity
Site work: stormwater, floodplain compensation	All of it, permitted and built up front	Same as Level 1	Same as Level 1
Pasture (Beginning Rancher herd)	Site pasture, conservative management ≈ 7 CE	Rotational grazing on site pasture ≈ 15 CE	Add the bonus pasture ≈ 28 CE
4-H cow & calf pens	Reuse the 7 existing pens 7 pens	Add one 14-pen barn 21 pens	Add a second 14-pen barn 35 pens
Pasture-stock handling	Holding pens 1 to 5, Bud Box, chute, and scale	Same as Level 1	Same as Level 1
Swine & small animals	Hogs move into the existing barn, about 32 pens; the 10 old hog pens give way to the site improvements	Small animal barn A, 32 pens: a clean swap that frees the existing barn for storage	Small animal barn B: extend south to the code limit, 5,500 sf
Poultry	In the unfinished barn	Same as Level 1	Same as Level 1
Arena / demonstration	None (use the turnout yards)	Grooming area	Arena, built out from the grooming area
Red House	Renovate: classroom, conference, 4 offices, demo kitchen	Add Office 5, men's & women's restrooms	Add event space / classroom addition + equipment carport
Residence	Hookups for a camper or RV	Same as Level 1	Residence
Horticulture	Raised beds and pots	Beds with irrigation	Structured shade area, planting tables, irrigation

CE from the pasture worksheet (UF/IFAS AN155); pens on the 7-pen module

Paddocks sized for rotation



LEVEL 1 Nine site paddocks

45.3 acres of site pasture, fenced into 9 paddocks around the campus. Managed conservatively, they carry the starting herd.

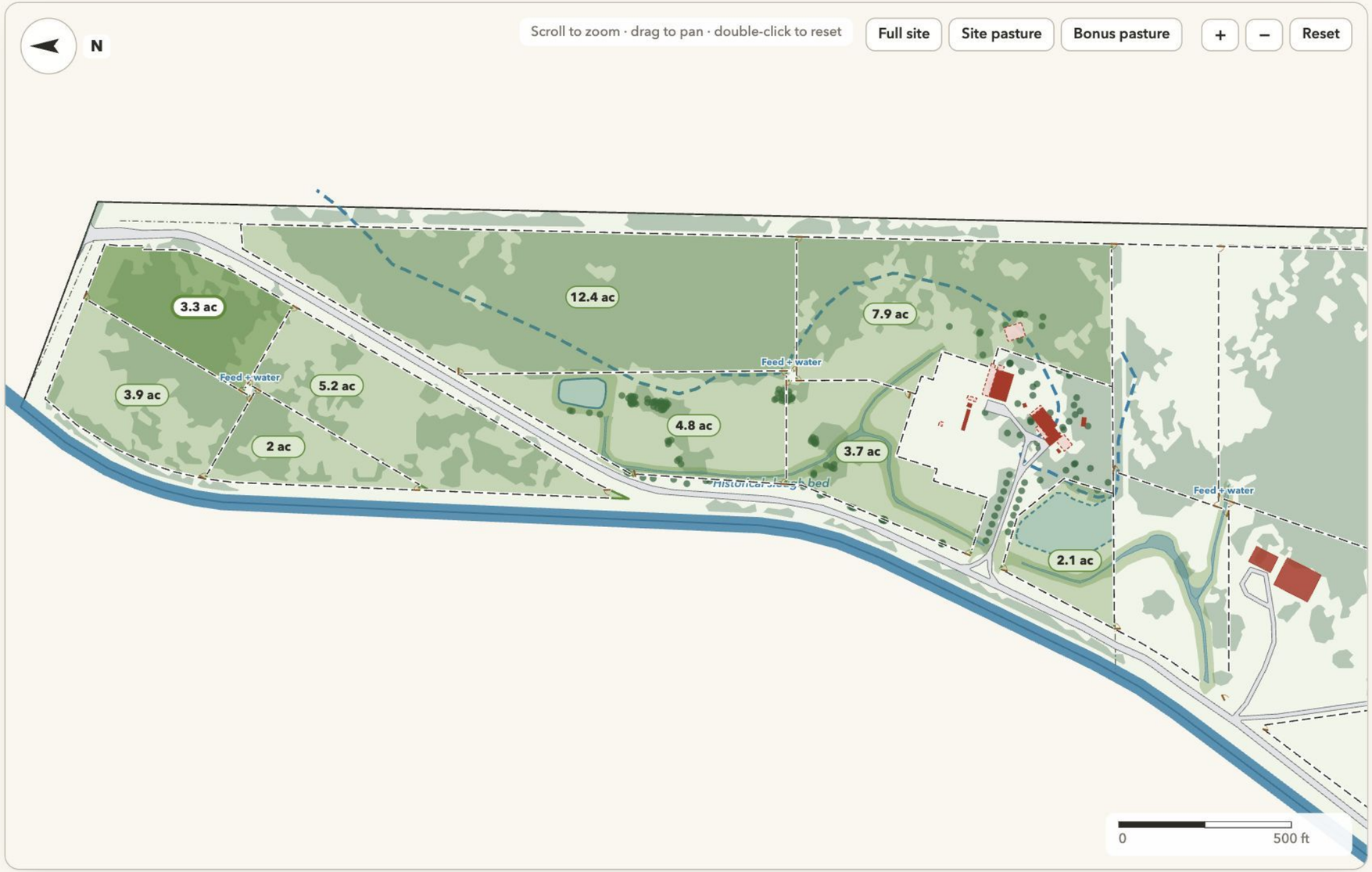
≈ 7 CE

LEVEL 2 Rotate through them

LEVEL 3 Add the bonus pasture

Proposed fencing plan A0.1 with surveyed trees. Capacity from the pasture worksheet (UF/IFAS AN155). Fence lines for all three Levels are shown throughout.

Paddocks sized for rotation



LEVEL 1 Nine site paddocks

LEVEL 2 Rotate through them

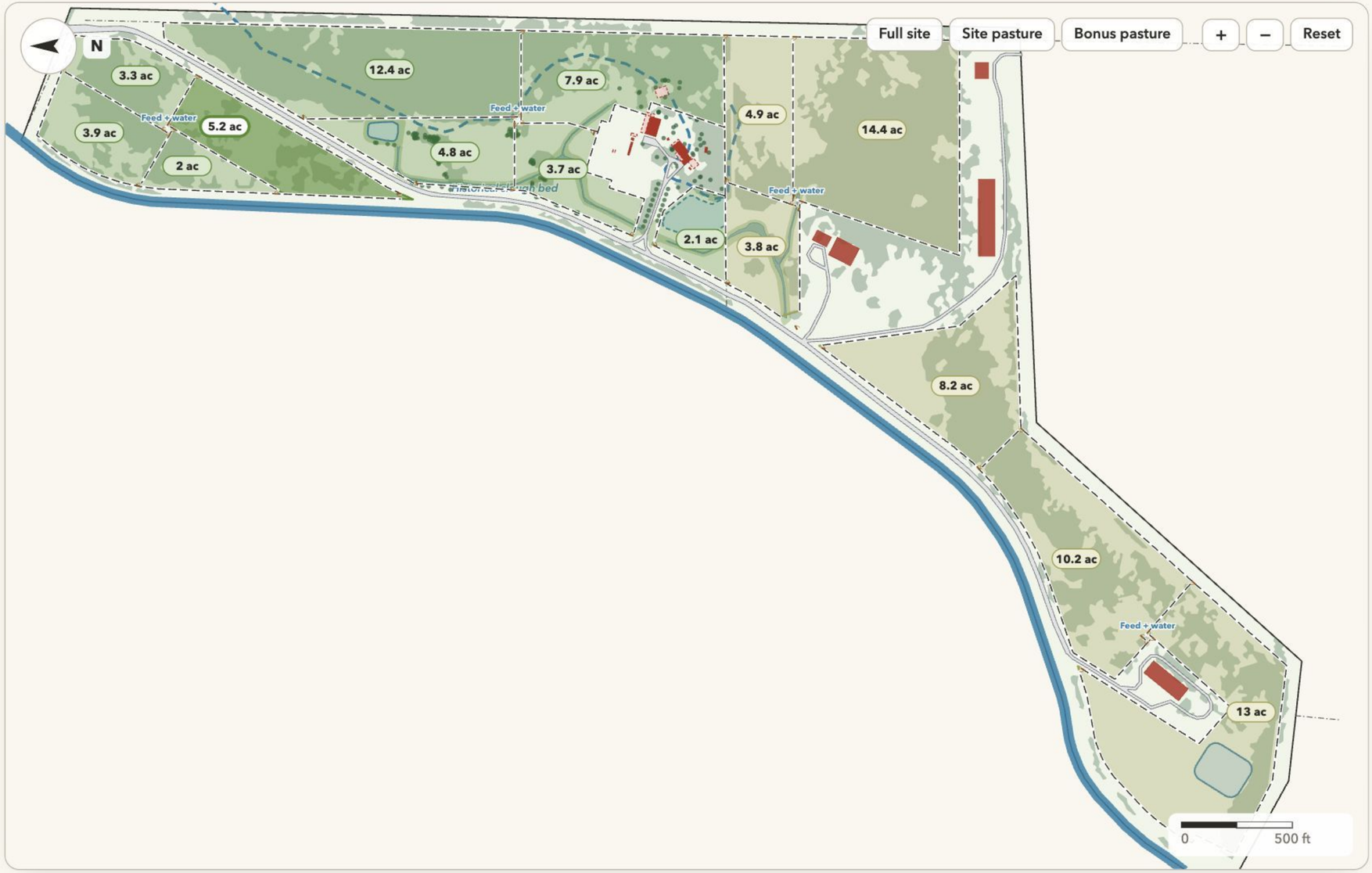
The same 9 paddocks, grazed in rotation so each one rests and regrows. Capacity roughly doubles without adding land.

≈ 15 CE

LEVEL 3 Add the bonus pasture

Proposed fencing plan A0.1 with surveyed trees. Capacity from the pasture worksheet (UF/IFAS AN155). Fence lines for all three Levels are shown throughout.

Paddocks sized for rotation



LEVEL 1 Nine site paddocks

LEVEL 2 Rotate through them

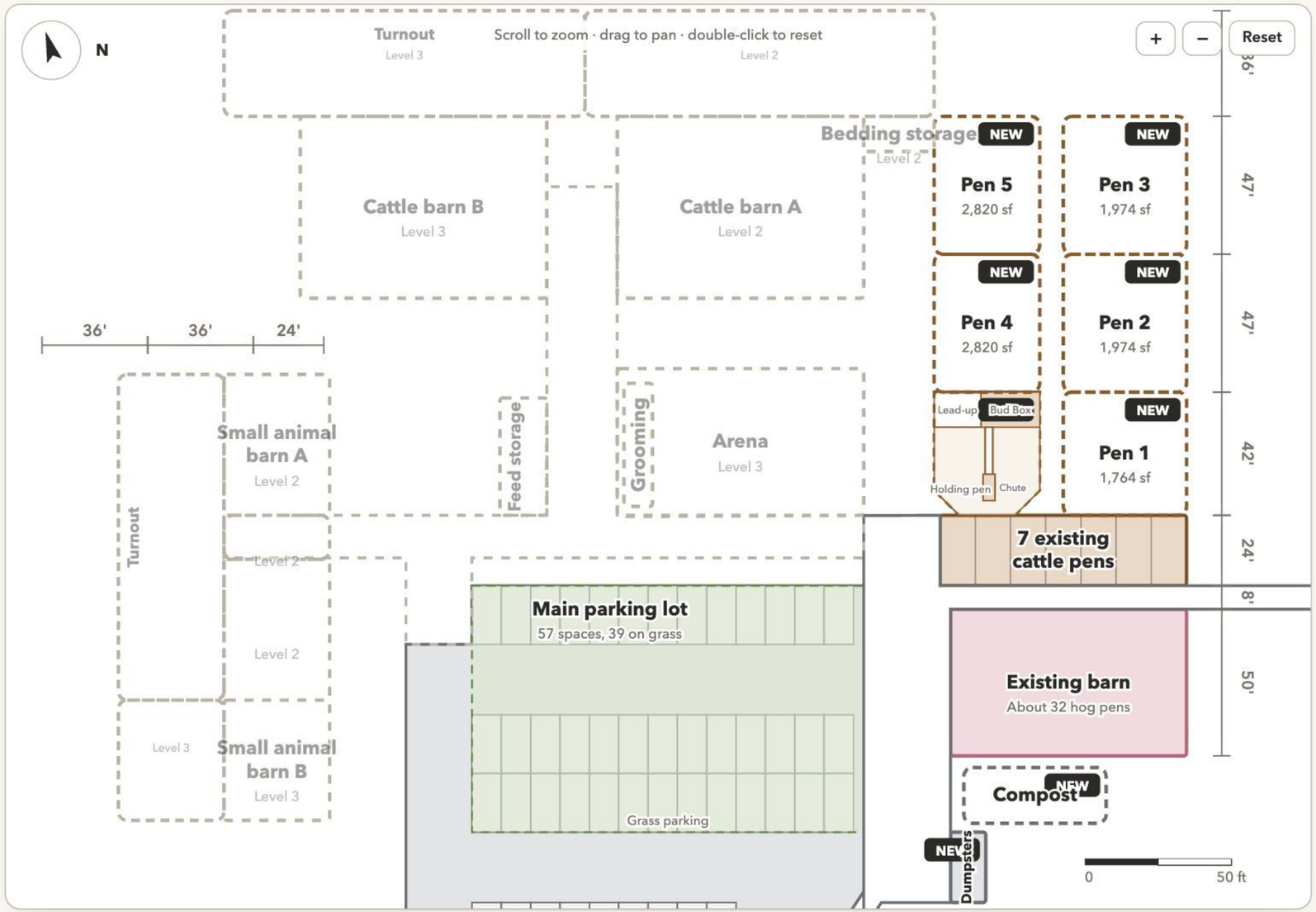
LEVEL 3 Add the bonus pasture

6 more paddocks on 54.5 acres of bonus land, rotated the same way.

≈ 28 CE

Proposed fencing plan A0.1 with surveyed trees. Capacity from the pasture worksheet (UF/IFAS AN155). Fence lines for all three Levels are shown throughout.

The barnyard, Level by Level



LEVEL 1 Lightest touch

- Hogs move into the existing barn, about 32 pens (the 10 old hog pens give way to the site improvements)
- 7 existing cattle pens reused
- Holding pens 1 to 5 and the handling yard: Bud Box, chute, and scale
- Compost area and dumpster enclosure south of the existing barn (could wait if funding is tight)
- Main parking lot, 57 spaces at 10' × 20'
- Walkways (white) tie the Red House, the parking, the existing barn and pens, and the poultry barn together (pan east for poultry)

LEVEL 2 First new barns

LEVEL 3 Best case

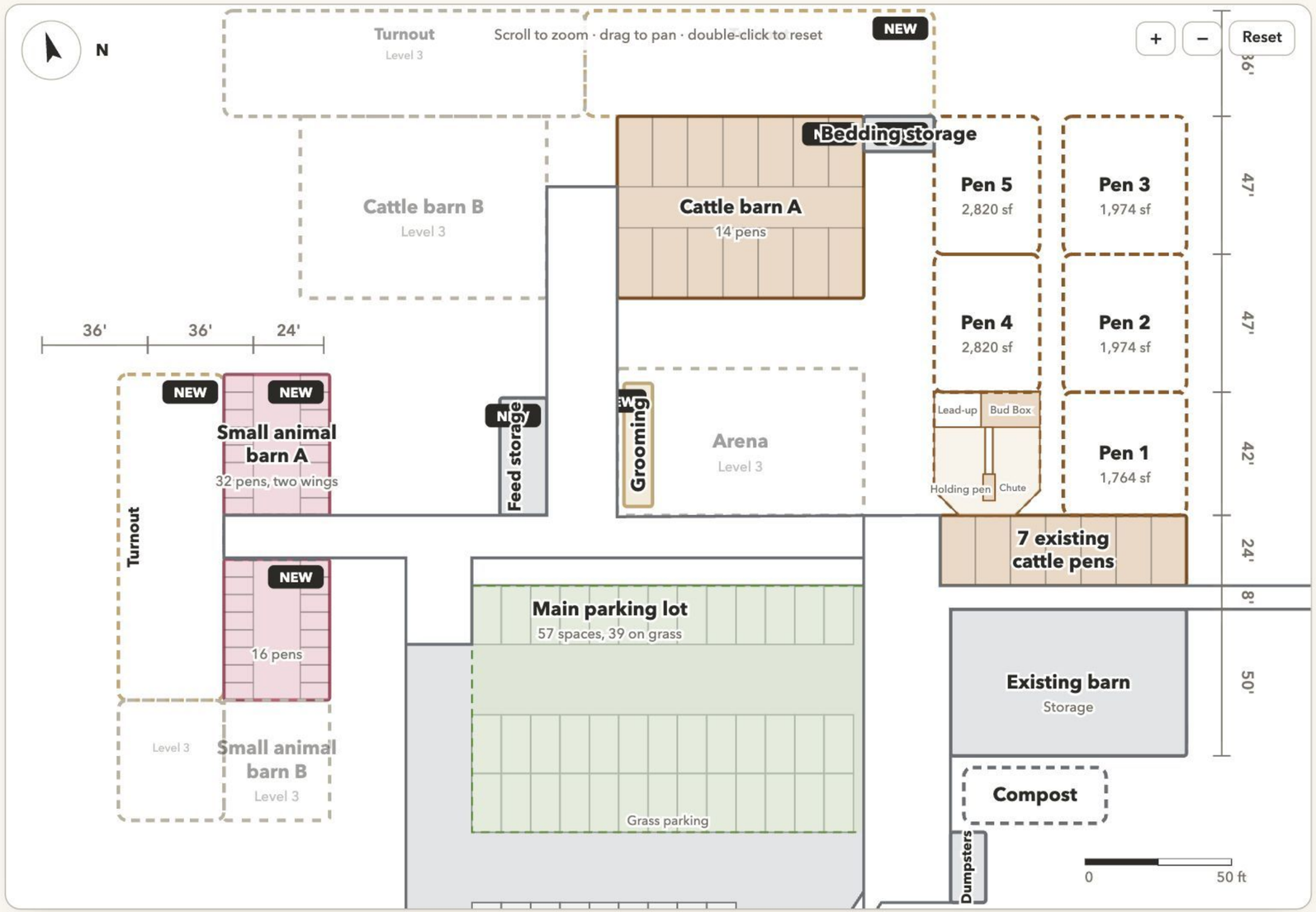
FLOW A two-way loop

- Cattle
- Swine
- Storage, parking, service
- Horticulture
- Small animals
- Arena and turnout
- Red House

Diagram to scale, in feet, drawn square to the existing barn. Everything sits on a 12' module with 24' lanes. Black arrows are vehicles and service; brown arrows are animals moving to turnout.

GROW BY MODULE

The barnyard, Level by Level



LEVEL 1 Lightest touch

LEVEL 2 First new barns

- Cattle barn A, with its turnout to the north: 21 pens in all
- Small animal barn A: two wings with a dogtrot, 32 pens, for hogs or small animals; the hogs move here, a clean swap
- Feed storage, and bedding storage beside cattle barn A
- Grooming area, at what becomes the arena's west end
- Walkways carried west along the arena to the new barns
- Existing barn, emptied of hogs, becomes much-needed storage

LEVEL 3 Best case

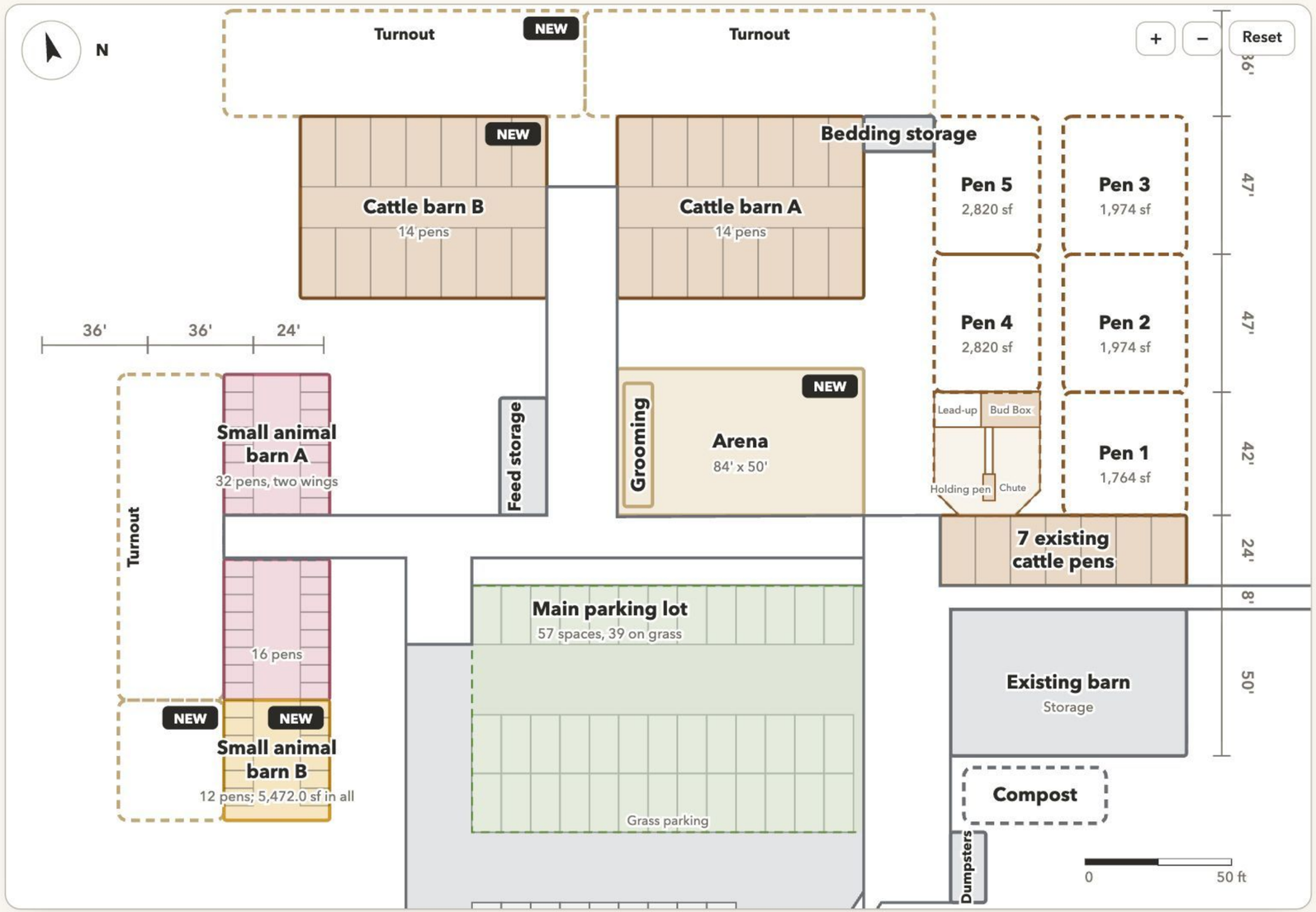
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Diagram to scale, in feet, drawn square to the existing barn. Everything sits on a 12' module with 24' lanes. Black arrows are vehicles and service; brown arrows are animals moving to turnout.

GROW BY MODULE

The barnyard, Level by Level



LEVEL 1 Lightest touch

LEVEL 2 First new barns

LEVEL 3 Best case

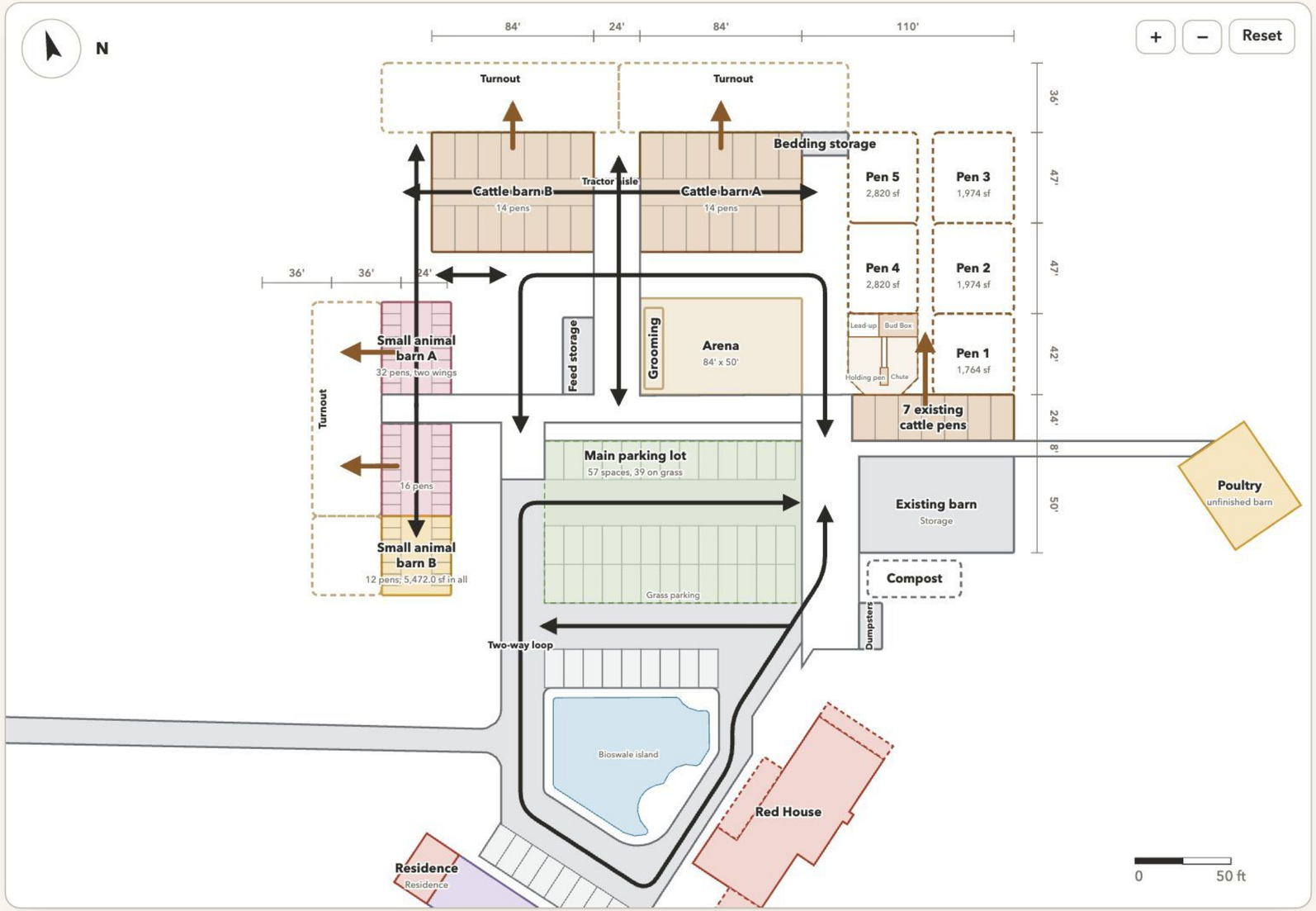
- Cattle barn B beside barn A, with its turnout: 35 pens in all
- Small animal barn B extends it south to the code limit for a Type VB utility building (5,500 sf): 44 small animal pens in all
- Arena, 84' × 50', built out from the grooming area
- 24' clear between all buildings

FLOW A two-way loop

- Cattle
- Swine
- Storage, parking, service
- Horticulture
- Small animals
- Arena and turnout
- Red House

Diagram to scale, in feet, drawn square to the existing barn. Everything sits on a 12' module with 24' lanes. Black arrows are vehicles and service; brown arrows are animals moving to turnout.

The barnyard, Level by Level



LEVEL 1 Lightest touch

LEVEL 2 First new barns

LEVEL 3 Best case

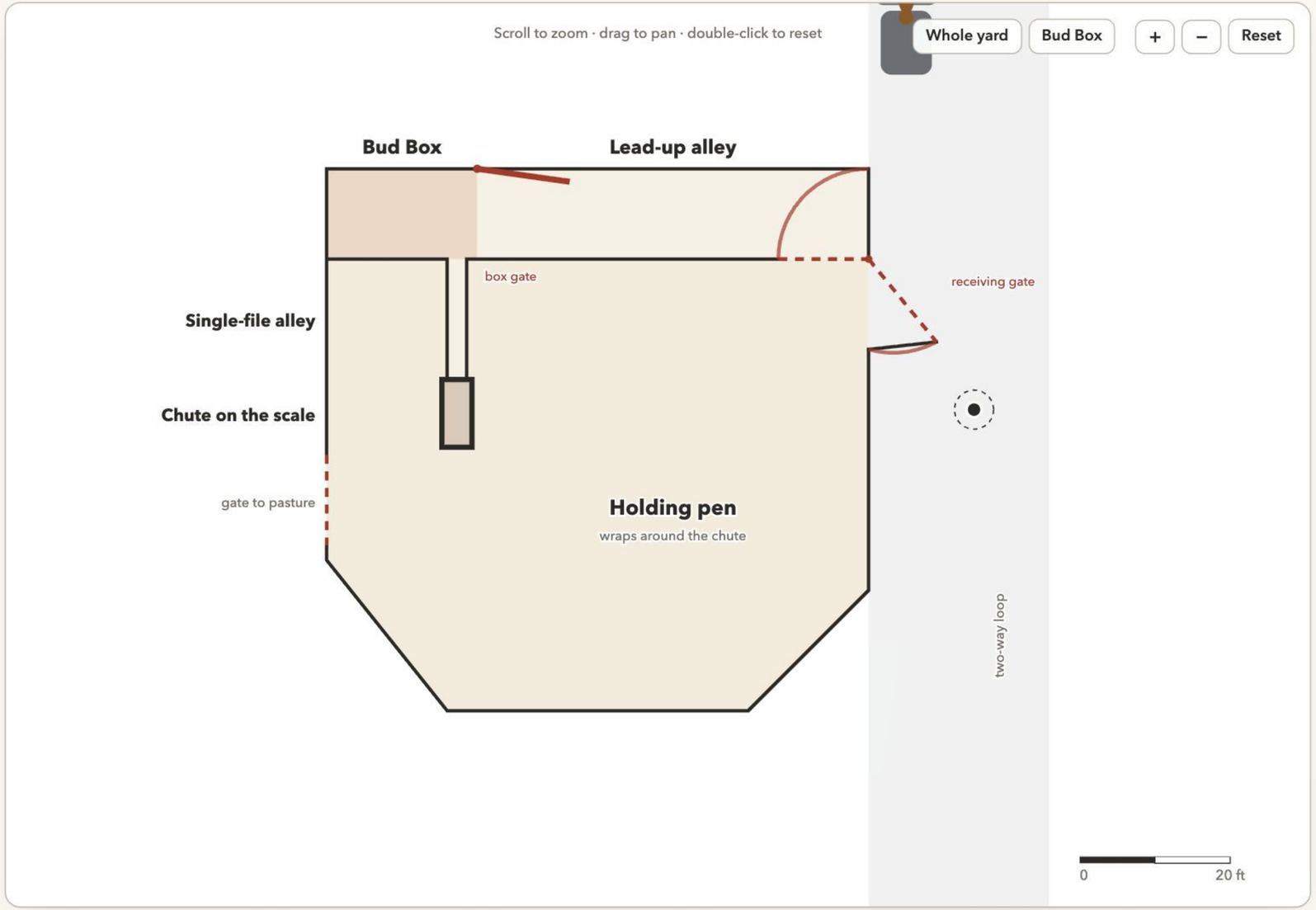
FLOW A two-way loop

- The parking loop and the service drive round the arena join into one two-way loop
- Stock trailers use the loop; no separate trailer enclosure is needed
- Every barn opens onto its own turnout
- The tractor aisle runs east-west through both cattle barns
- The gap between the cattle barns is the busiest route: animals go to the grooming area daily

- Cattle
- Swine
- Storage, parking, service
- Horticulture
- Small animals
- Arena and turnout
- Red House

Diagram to scale, in feet, drawn square to the existing barn. Everything sits on a 12' module with 24' lanes. Black arrows are vehicles and service; brown arrows are animals moving to turnout.

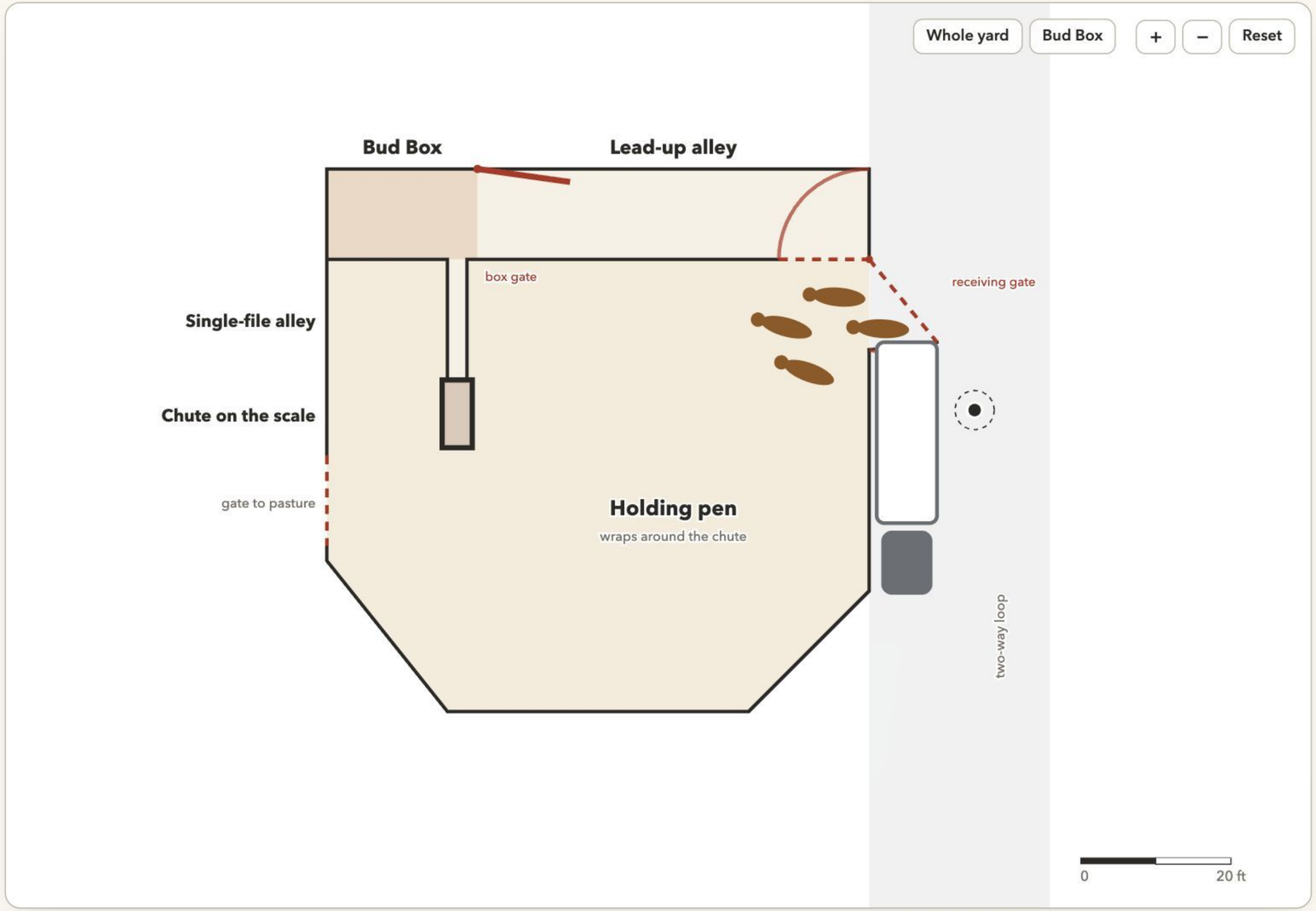
Working cattle: the Bud Box



1. **Arrive**
   A stock trailer comes in on the loop from the north, along the yard's east fence.
2. Pull up and unload
3. Hold
4. Into the lead-up alley
5. Into the box
6. They turn back
7. Past the handler
8. Single file to the chute

Option B uses this yard mirrored (the loop on its west side) and sized for four cattle, 36' × 42' with 12' corner panels. Diagram to scale, in feet. Layout from the study plan, after the Priefert Bud Box. No trailer enclosure: trailers unload from the loop straight into the holding pen. Sizes follow extension guidance (K-State MF3349, Missouri G2003): box 12' wide for handlers on foot and 20' deep. The 16' single-file alley plus the chute holds four cattle.

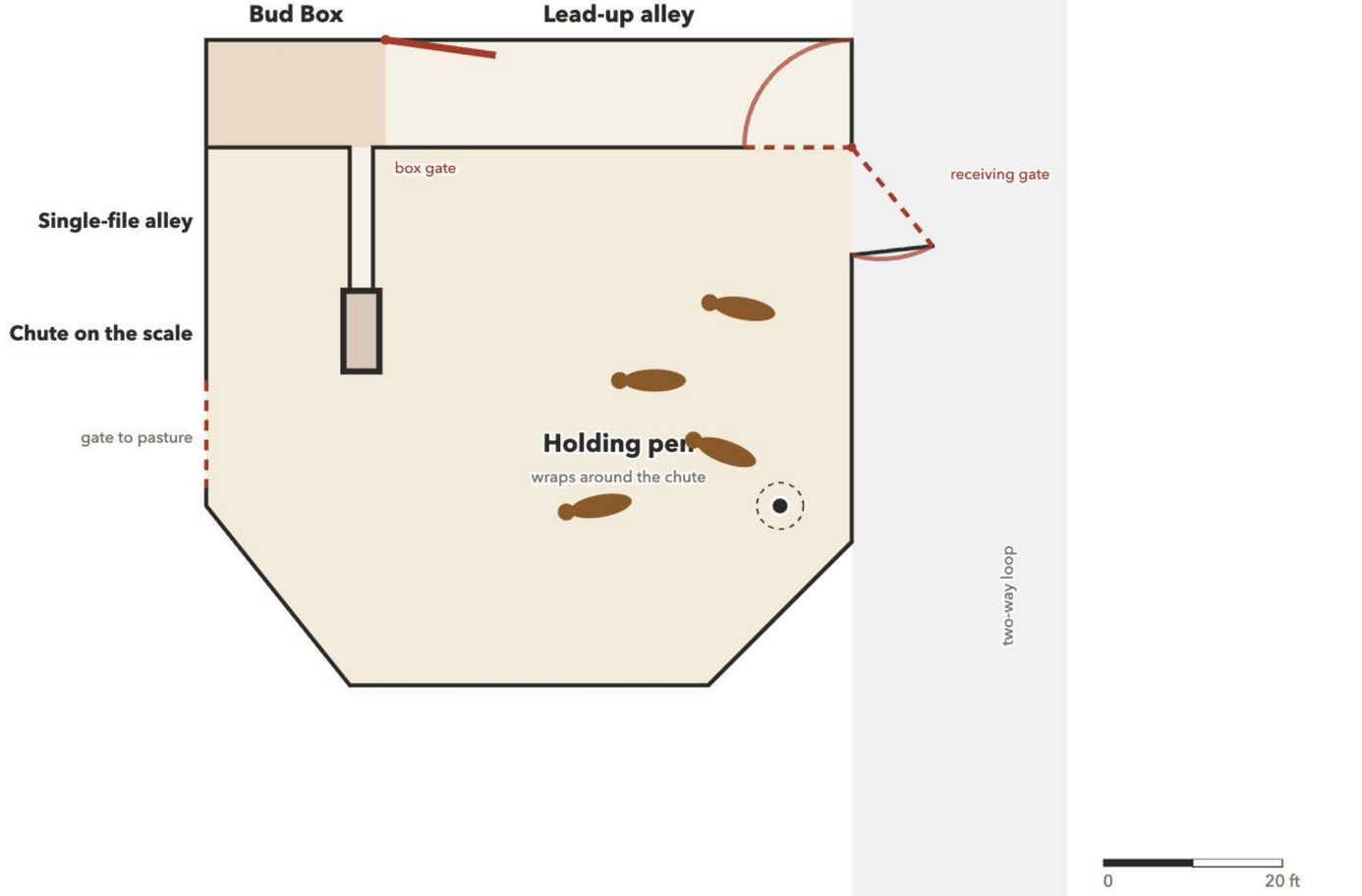
Working cattle: the Bud Box



1. **Arrive**
2. **Pull up and unload**
   A stock trailer pulls up on the loop right beside the yard's fence. The receiving gate at the top corner swings out to the back of the trailer, and the cattle walk straight into the holding pen.
3. **Hold**
4. **Into the lead-up alley**
5. **Into the box**
6. **They turn back**
7. **Past the handler**
8. **Single file to the chute**

Option B uses this yard mirrored (the loop on its west side) and sized for four cattle, 36' × 42' with 12' corner panels. Diagram to scale, in feet. Layout from the study plan, after the Priefert Bud Box. No trailer enclosure: trailers unload from the loop straight into the holding pen. Sizes follow extension guidance (K-State MF3349, Missouri G2003): box 12' wide for handlers on foot and 20' deep. The 16' single-file alley plus the chute holds four cattle.

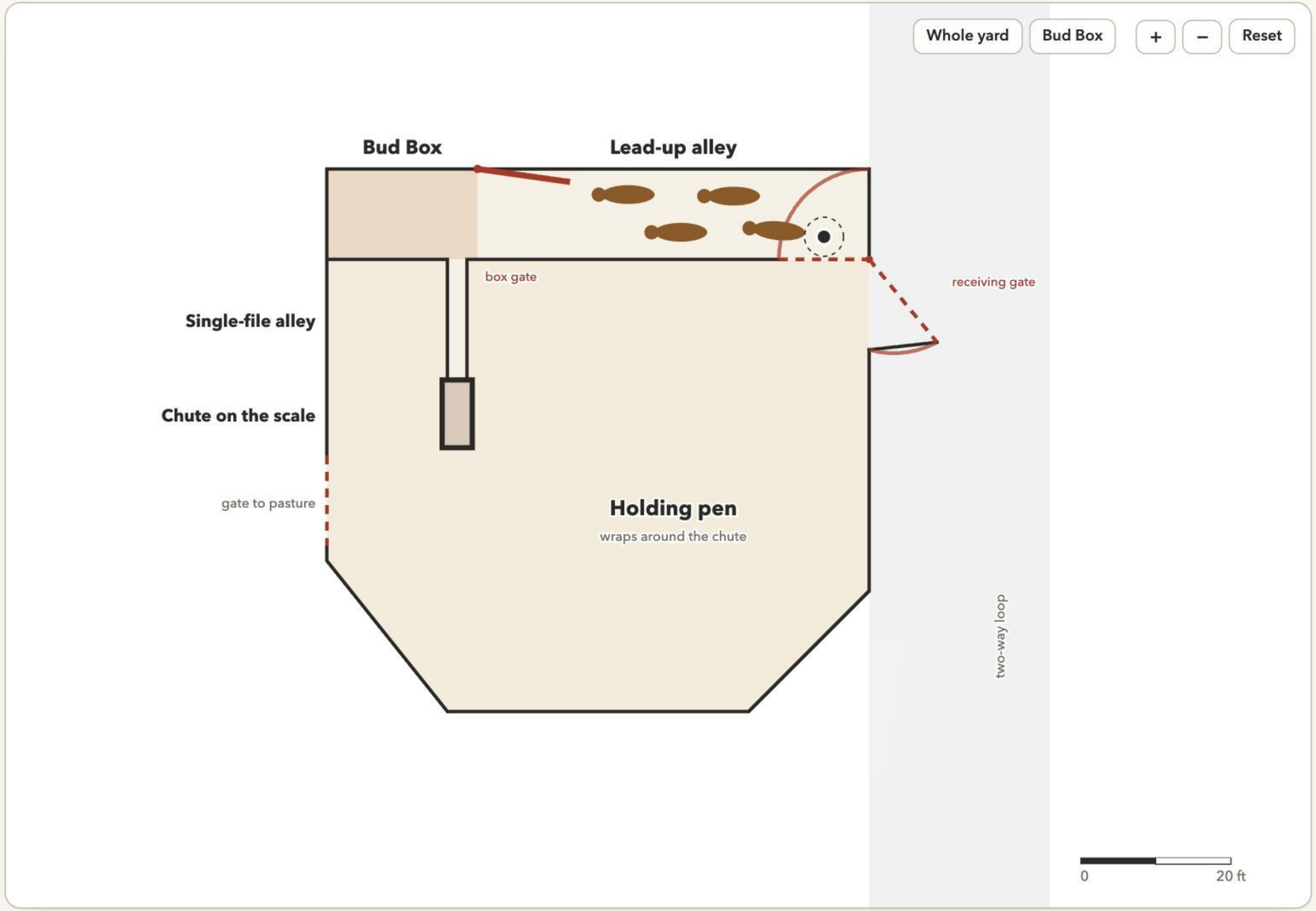
Working cattle: the Bud Box



1. **Arrive**
2. **Pull up and unload**
3. **Hold**
   Cattle settle in the holding pen, which wraps around the chute. Chamfered corners keep them moving toward the lead-up alley.
4. **Into the lead-up alley**
5. **Into the box**
6. **They turn back**
7. **Past the handler**
8. **Single file to the chute**

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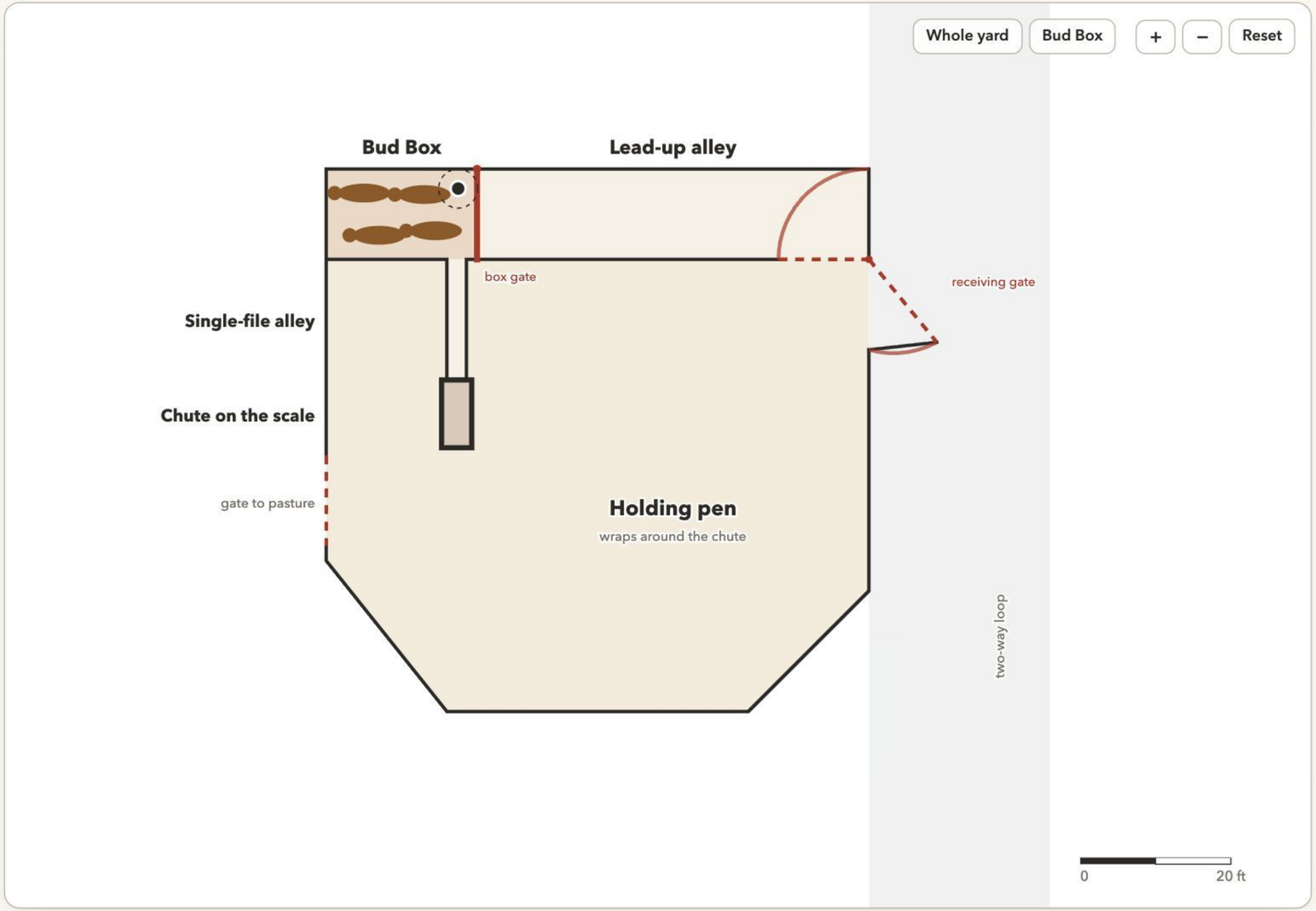
Working cattle: the Bud Box



1. **Arrive**
2. **Pull up and unload**
3. **Hold**
4. **Into the lead-up alley**
   A small group, four head at most, walks out of the pen and up the wide alley toward the box.
5. **Into the box**
6. **They turn back**
7. **Past the handler**
8. **Single file to the chute**

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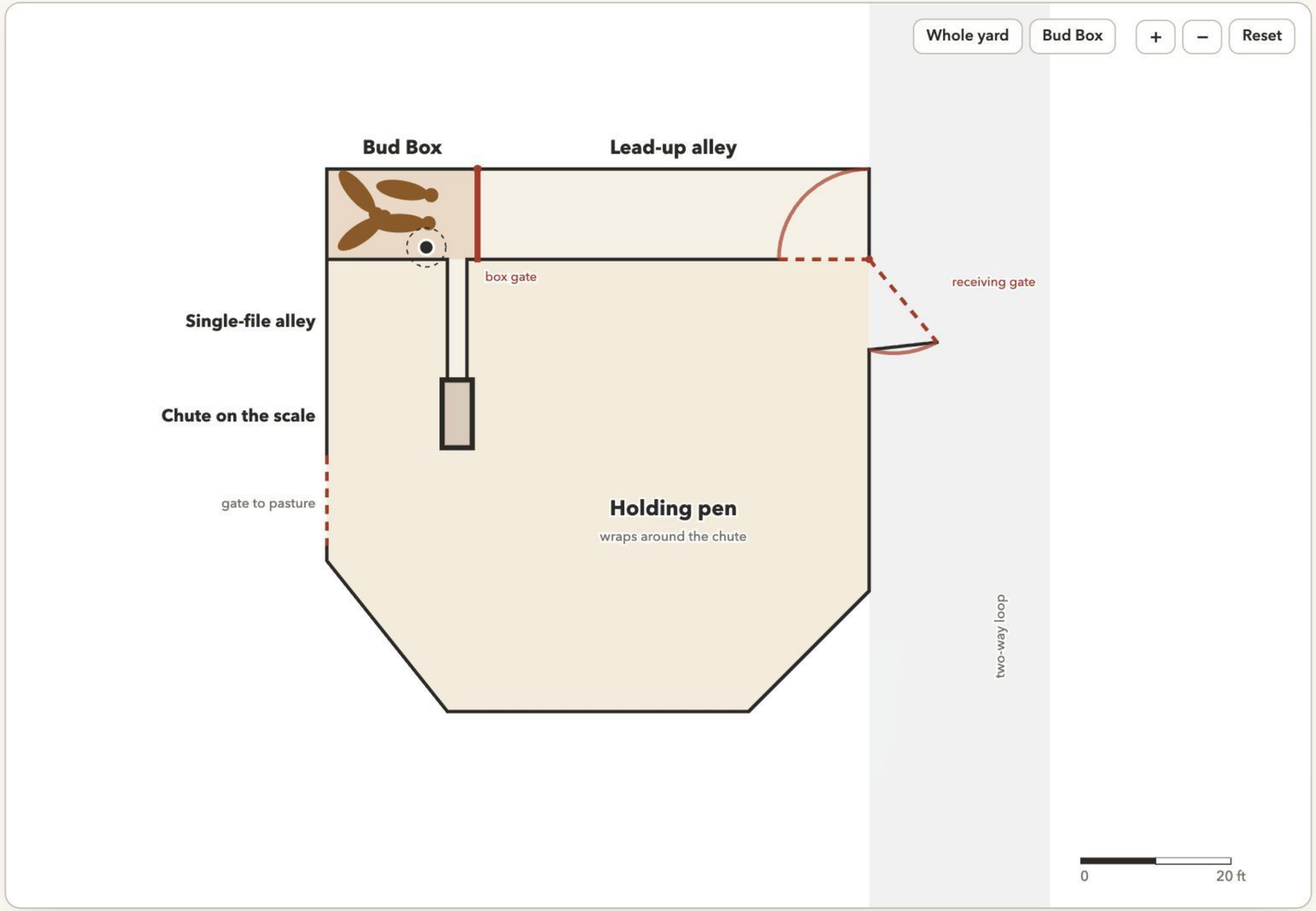
Working cattle: the Bud Box



1. **Arrive**
2. **Pull up and unload**
3. **Hold**
4. **Into the lead-up alley**
5. **Into the box**
   They pass the gate into the box and it closes behind them.
6. **They turn back**
7. **Past the handler**
8. **Single file to the chute**

Option B uses this yard mirrored (the loop on its west side) and sized for four cattle, 36' × 42' with 12' corner panels. Diagram to scale, in feet. Layout from the study plan, after the Priefert Bud Box. No trailer enclosure: trailers unload from the loop straight into the holding pen. Sizes follow extension guidance (K-State MF3349, Missouri G2003): box 12' wide for handlers on foot and 20' deep. The 16' single-file alley plus the chute holds four cattle.

Working cattle: the Bud Box

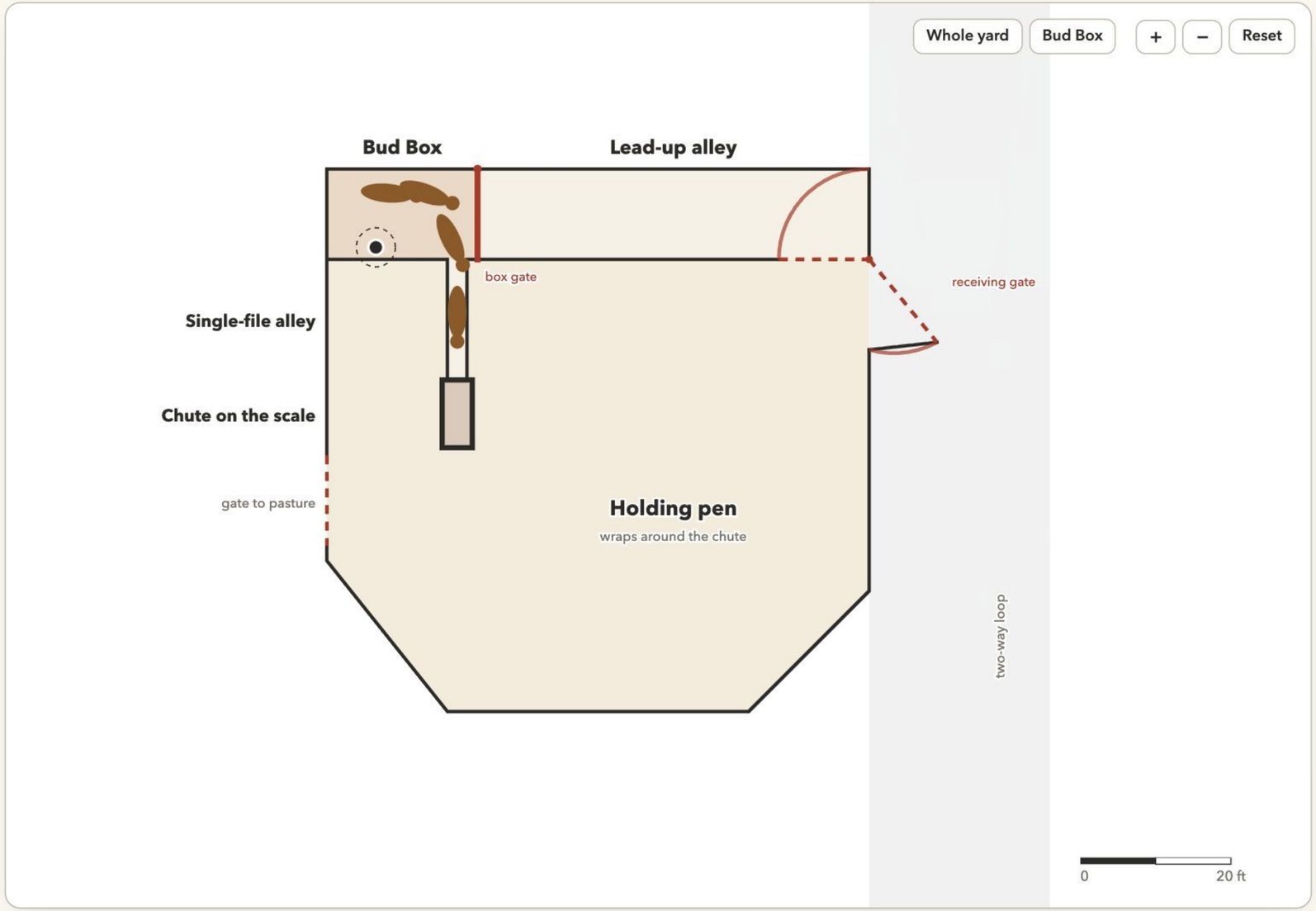


1. **Arrive**
2. **Pull up and unload**
3. **Hold**
4. **Into the lead-up alley**
5. **Into the box**
6. **They turn back**

   At the dead end the cattle turn back toward the gate they came through. The single-file alley opens right beside it.
7. **Past the handler**
8. **Single file to the chute**

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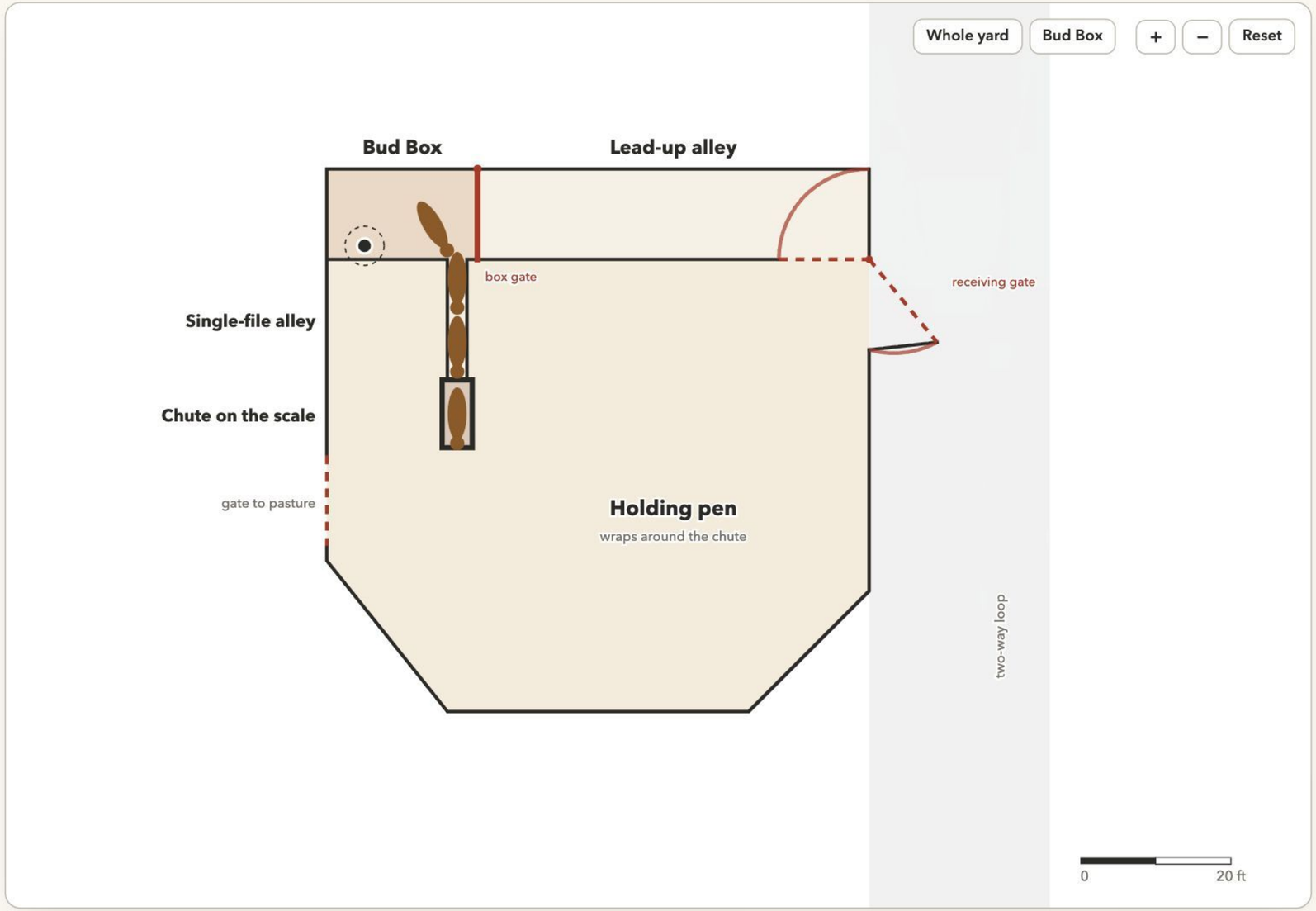


1. **Arrive**
2. **Pull up and unload**
3. **Hold**
4. **Into the lead-up alley**
5. **Into the box**
6. **They turn back**
7. **Past the handler**

   The handler walks the alley-side fence toward the closed end. The cattle pass and turn into the alley on their own.
8. **Single file to the chute**

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3. **Hold**
4. **Into the lead-up alley**
5. **Into the box**
6. **They turn back**
7. **Past the handler**
8. **Single file to the chute**
   One at a time through the squeeze chute, which sits on the scale, then back to the pen or out to pasture.

> Cattle want to go back the way they came, and to move around the person working them. The box uses both instincts. Cattle flow through it; they are never held in it.

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The barnyard, on the site



LEVEL 1 **What is there today, put to work**

The existing barn and its seven pens, holding pens 1 to 5 and the handling yard north of them, compost and dumpsters, the parking lot on the existing drive, and walkways linking the Red House, the parking, the existing barn, and the poultry barn. The entry gets a new apron off the lane, which the stormwater design requires.

LEVEL 2 First barns

LEVEL 3 Full barnyard

SITE In its pasture

The barnyard diagram placed to scale on the survey, pinned to the existing barn's surveyed pen line. North is to the left.

The barnyard, on the site



LEVEL 1 What is there today, put to work

LEVEL 2 First barns

Cattle barn A with its turnout to the north, small animal barn A (two wings with a dogtrot), feed and bedding storage, the grooming area, and the walkways carried west to the new barns.

LEVEL 3 Full barnyard

SITE In its pasture

The barnyard diagram placed to scale on the survey, pinned to the existing barn's surveyed pen line. North is to the left.

The barnyard, on the site



LEVEL 1 What is there today, put to work

LEVEL 2 First barns

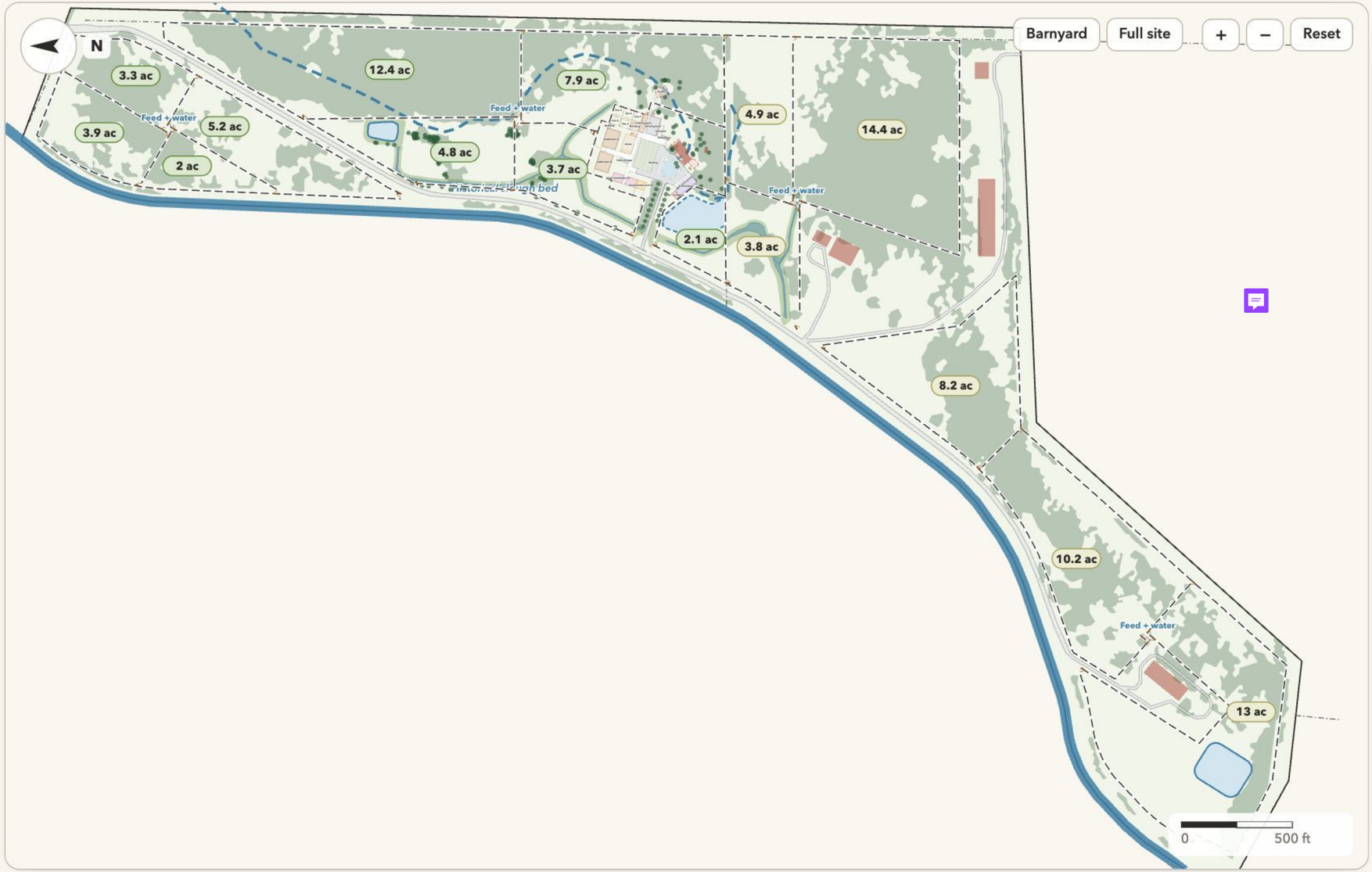
LEVEL 3 Full barnyard

Cattle barn B beside barn A, the arena around the grooming area, and small animal barn B, extending barn A south to the code limit.

SITE In its pasture

The barnyard diagram placed to scale on the survey, pinned to the existing barn's surveyed pen line. North is to the left.

The barnyard, on the site



LEVEL 1 What is there today, put to work

LEVEL 2 First barns

LEVEL 3 Full barnyard

SITE In its pasture

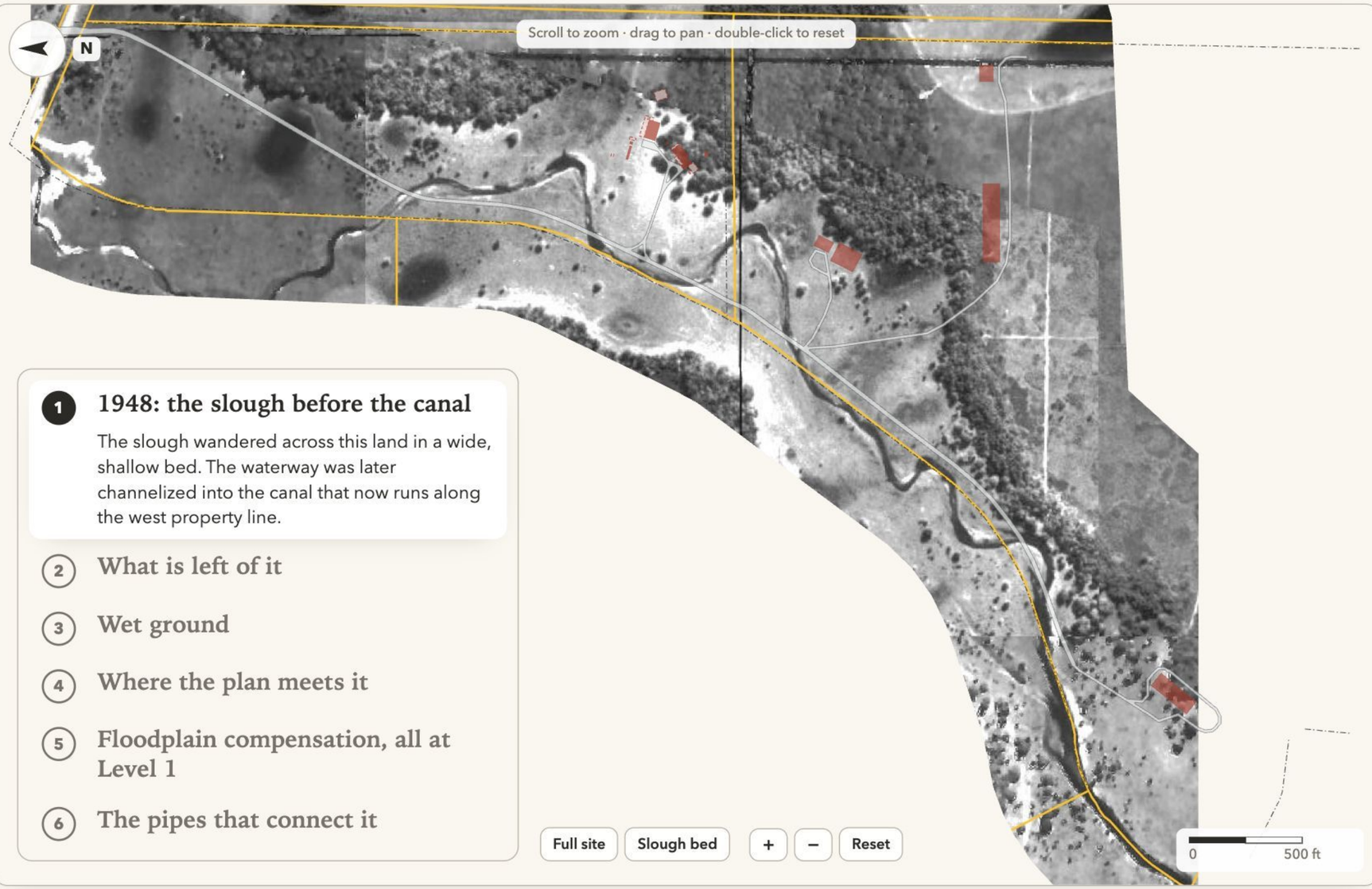
The whole barnyard takes up a small corner of the site. The paddocks wrap around it.

What the overlay shows

- Surveyed trees inside new footprints: 5 in the main parking lot, 1 in the dumpsters. They include the row along the existing drive.
- Two existing structures (35' × 29', 61' × 25') sit under Arena.
- No building sits on the wettest soil.
- The south stall row is about 30' from the nearest Red House wall, so the loop's east leg has to bend around it.

The barnyard diagram placed to scale on the survey, pinned to the existing barn's surveyed pen line. North is to the left.

Water on the site



1 1948: the slough before the canal

The slough wandered across this land in a wide, shallow bed. The waterway was later channelized into the canal that now runs along the west property line.

2 What is left of it

3 Wet ground

4 Where the plan meets it

5 Floodplain compensation, all at Level 1

6 The pipes that connect it

Full site | Slough bed | + | − | Reset

1948 aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser, placed by matching its parcel lines to the current aerial's; its position is approximate. Slough bed: top of bank and toe of slope from the survey. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions. North is to the left.

Water on the site



3.4
acres of historical slough bed, bank to bank

1948 aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser, placed by matching its parcel lines to the current aerial's; its position is approximate. Slough bed: top of bank and toe of slope from the survey. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions. North is to the left.

Water on the site

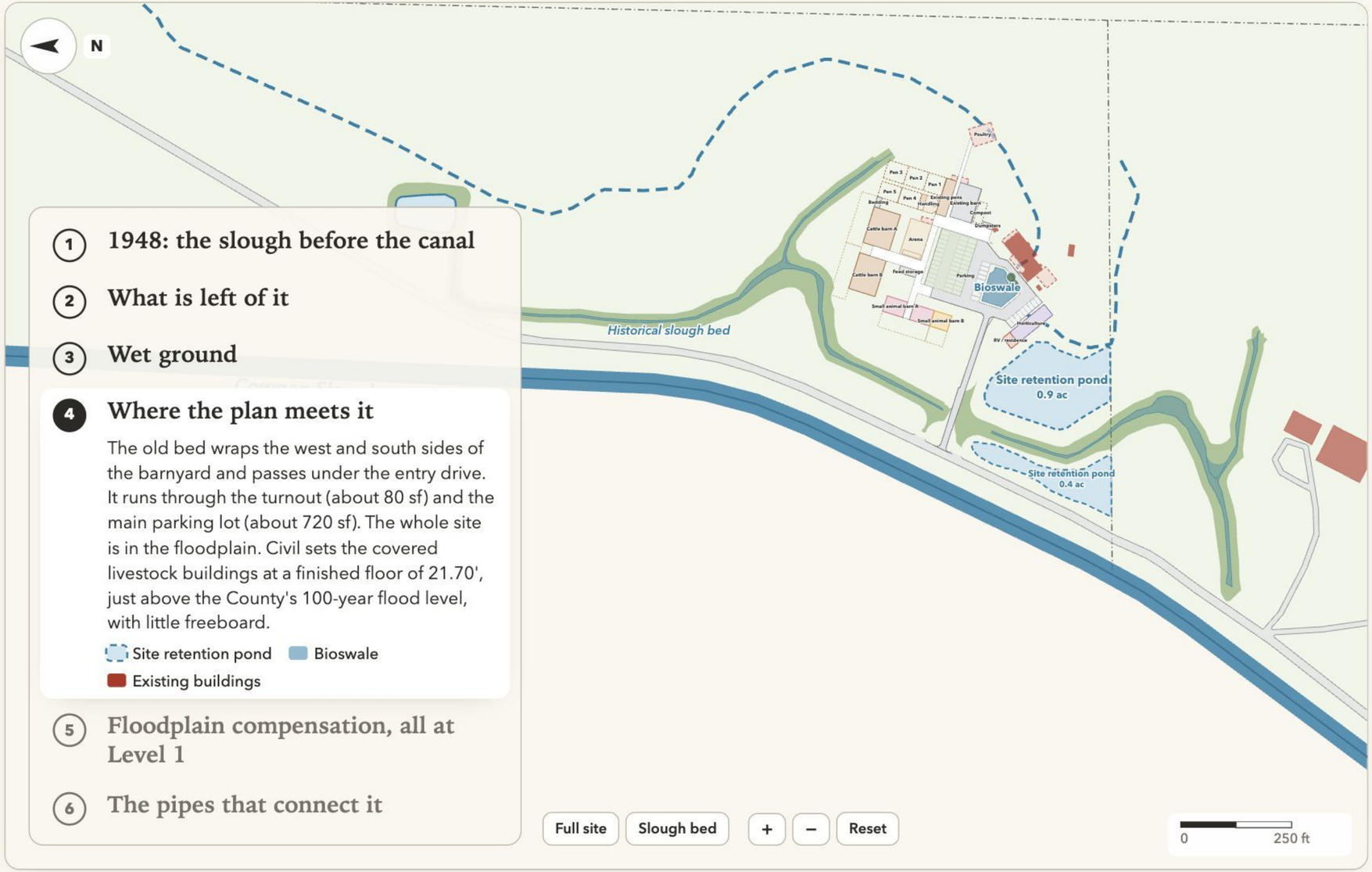


3.4
acres of historical slough bed, bank to bank

24%
of the mapped site is very poorly drained

1948 aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser, placed by matching its parcel lines to the current aerial's; its position is approximate. Slough bed: top of bank and toe of slope from the survey. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions. North is to the left.

Water on the site



1. **1948: the slough before the canal**
2. **What is left of it**
3. **Wet ground**
4. **Where the plan meets it**

   The old bed wraps the west and south sides of the barnyard and passes under the entry drive. It runs through the turnout (about 80 sf) and the main parking lot (about 720 sf). The whole site is in the floodplain. Civil sets the covered livestock buildings at a finished floor of 21.70', just above the County's 100-year flood level, with little freeboard.

   Site retention pond · Bioswale · Existing buildings

5. **Floodplain compensation, all at Level 1**
6. **The pipes that connect it**

3.4
acres of historical slough bed, bank to bank

24%
of the mapped site is very poorly drained

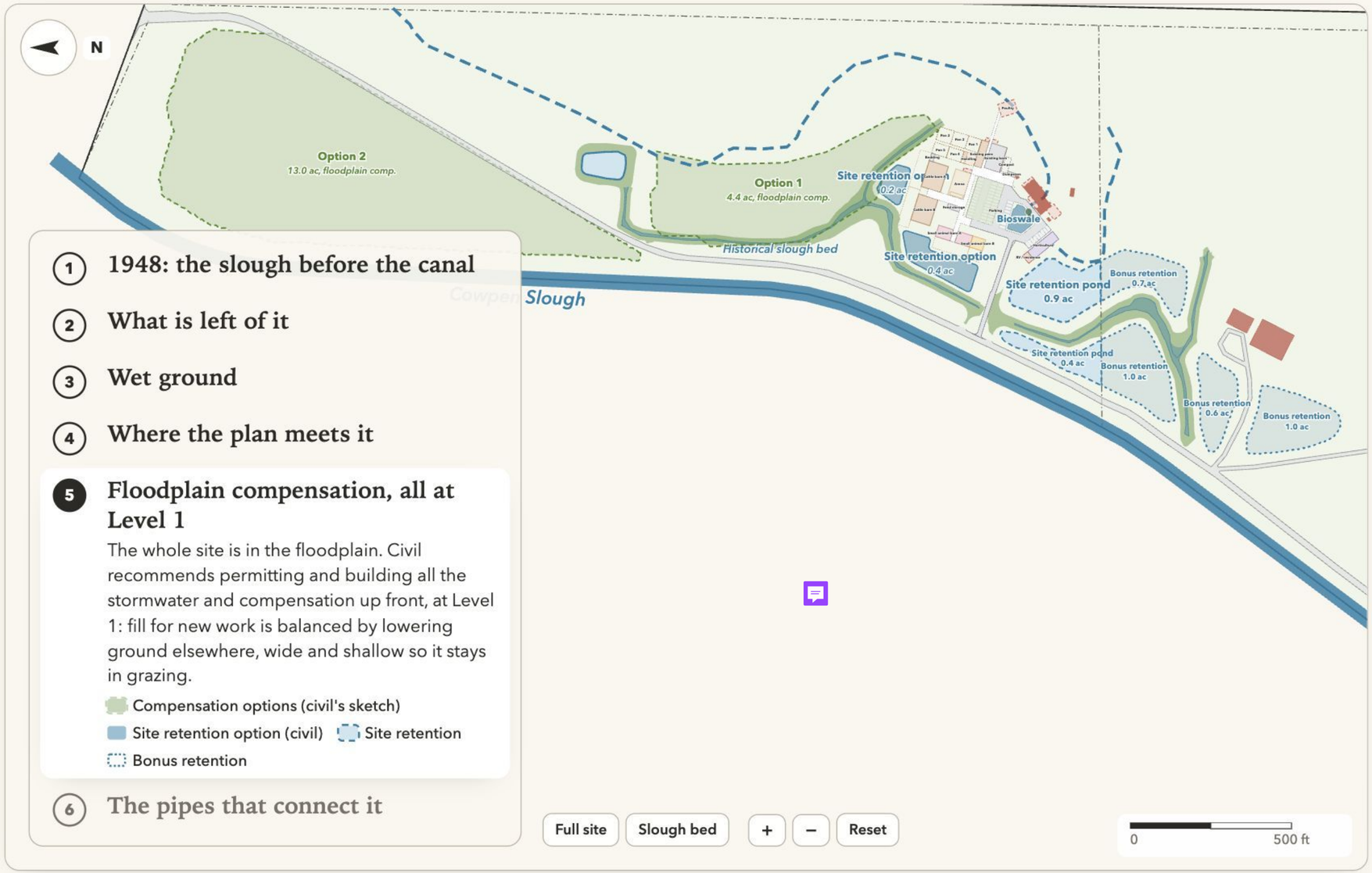
21.70'
finished floor for covered livestock buildings, just above the 100-year flood

FOR THE TABLES

How sacred is the historical slough bed? It conflicts with some of the program and makes the civil design harder to work around.

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Water on the site



3.4
acres of historical slough bed, bank to bank

24%
of the mapped site is very poorly drained

21.70'
finished floor for covered livestock buildings, just above the 100-year flood

FOR THE TABLES

How sacred is the historical slough bed? It conflicts with some of the program and makes the civil design harder to work around.

Option 1, about 4.4 ac north-west of the campus: strip topsoil, reseed. Drainage unchanged.

Option 2, about 13 ac, the north pasture: clear and lower. Costlier; the biggest gain in forage.

Site retention option, about 0.6 ac (0.2 and 0.4 ac): civil's expanded retention, refitted clear of the turnouts.

Site retention, about 1.3 ac in all: the pond by the campus (0.9 ac) and a second between the old bed and the lane (0.4 ac).

Bonus retention, about 3.3 ac in all (1.0, 0.7, 0.6, 1.0 ac), on Solid Waste land: both site ponds extend south, plus two ponds past the outfall drive.

The soil removed could cover the County landfill next door.

1948 aerial: Sarasota County Property Appraiser, placed by matching its parcel lines to the current aerial's; its position is approximate. Slough bed: top of bank and toe of slope from the survey. Soil drainage classes follow NRCS series descriptions. North is to the left.

Water on the site



1. **1948: the slough before the canal**
2. **What is left of it**
3. **Wet ground**
4. **Where the plan meets it**
5. **Floodplain compensation, all at Level 1**
6. **The pipes that connect it**

   Two structures tie the old bed together. The culvert under the entry is undersized and hard to maintain: it is replaced with the new entry apron at Level 1. The outfall from the bed to Cow Pen Slough, two 36-inch pipes under the lane, is in good shape and sized for what the plan needs, so it stays.

Replace · Keep

3.4
acres of historical slough bed, bank to bank

24%
of the mapped site is very poorly drained

21.70'
finished floor for covered livestock buildings, just above the 100-year flood

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Water quality, built into the plan

The site drains to Cowpen Slough. The plan follows the region's Water Quality Playbook: reduce nutrients at the source, remove what does run off, and sustain the practice by teaching it.

REDUCE

Keep nutrients on the land

Stock to what the pasture carries. 7, 15, then 28 cow equivalents, never more than the grass supports.
Playbook 4.6: adaptive grazing

Rotate, and rest the wet ground. Paddocks on the wettest soils are grazed only when conditions allow.
Playbook 4.6: rotational grazing

Manage manure and bedding. Collected from pens and barns and composted, not left to wash away.
Playbook 4.6 and 4.7: manure management, composting

Check the Red House septic against its new use before it reopens.
Playbook chapter 2: septic systems

REMOVE

Catch and treat what runs off

Retention area and bioswale take runoff from the parking, drives, and roofs before it reaches the slough. The stormwater design also calls for a new entry apron, built at Level 1. All stormwater and floodplain compensation is permitted and built at Level 1; civil's strategy is wide, shallow compensation areas that stay in grazing, an expanded retention area, and the historical flows left largely as they are.
Playbook chapters 6 and 7: stormwater

Washdown water is collected, never discharged to pasture, wetland, or ditch.

Deep overhangs and gutters on every barn keep roof water out of the bedding and the pens.

Wooded and wet edges stay vegetated between the pastures and the slough.
Playbook 8.1: wetland and shoreline habitat

SUSTAIN

Teach it, and show it working

Best practices are the curriculum. Beginning ranchers and 4-H youth learn grazing, manure, and soil management by doing them here.
Playbook 4.6: education for farmers and ranchers

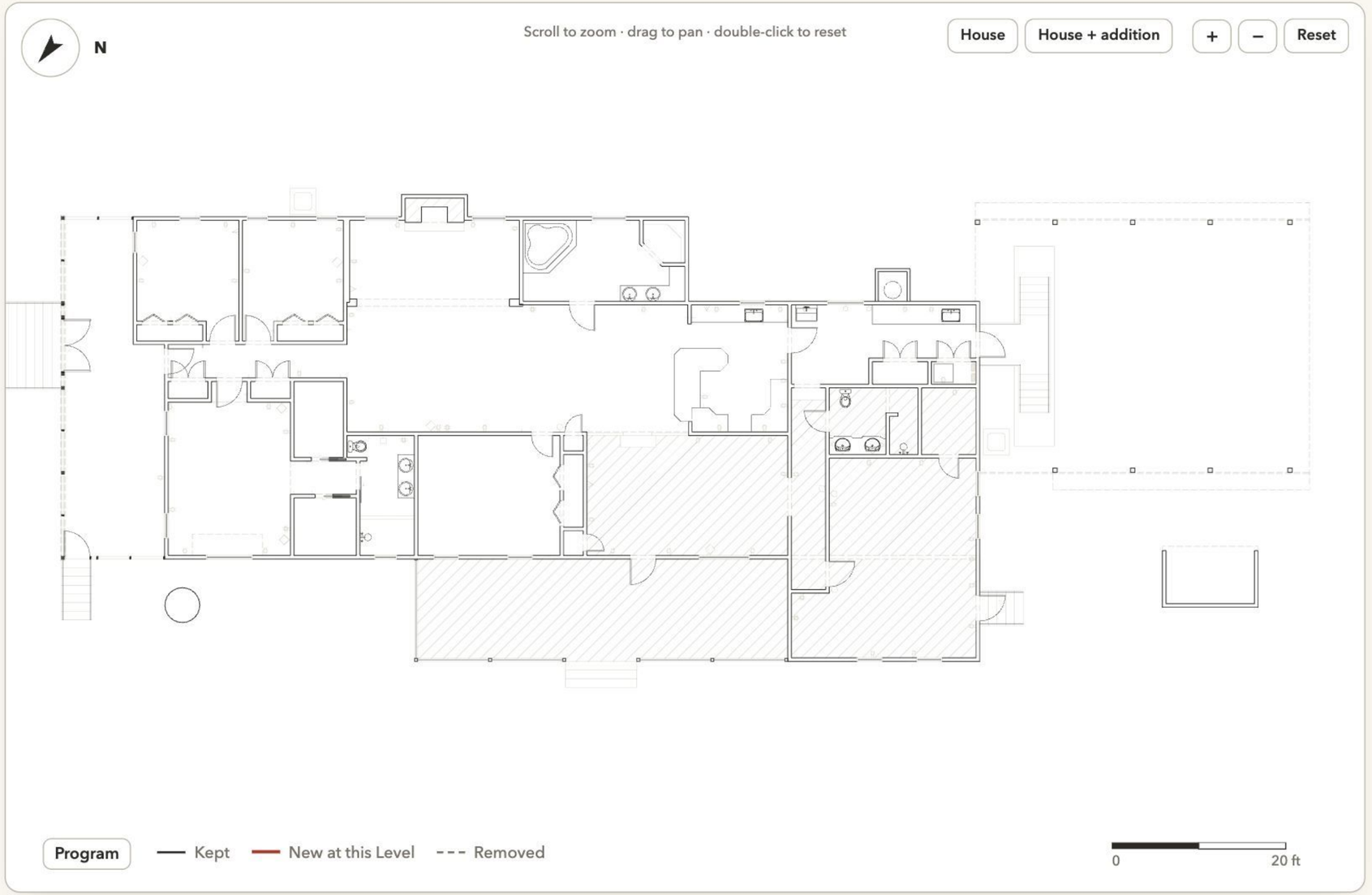
A working demonstration, open to the public, of stormwater features on a farm.
Playbook 7.4: demonstration projects

Soil health in the horticulture area: compost in, synthetic fertilizer down.
Playbook 4.7: rebuilding soils

1 in 3 Only about a third of Sarasota County's farms under 10 acres follow agricultural best management practices, and small animal farms and hobbyists are the hardest group to reach. They are exactly who this center teaches.

2025 Water Quality Playbook, Gulf Coast Community Foundation (waterqualityplaybook.org); farm figures from its action 4.6, citing USDA 2022. Site measures are from the draft program criteria and the study plan.

One house, three Levels of reuse



EXISTING The house today

A former residence with several floor levels, small rooms, and wraparound porches. The study keeps the shell and its Old Florida character.

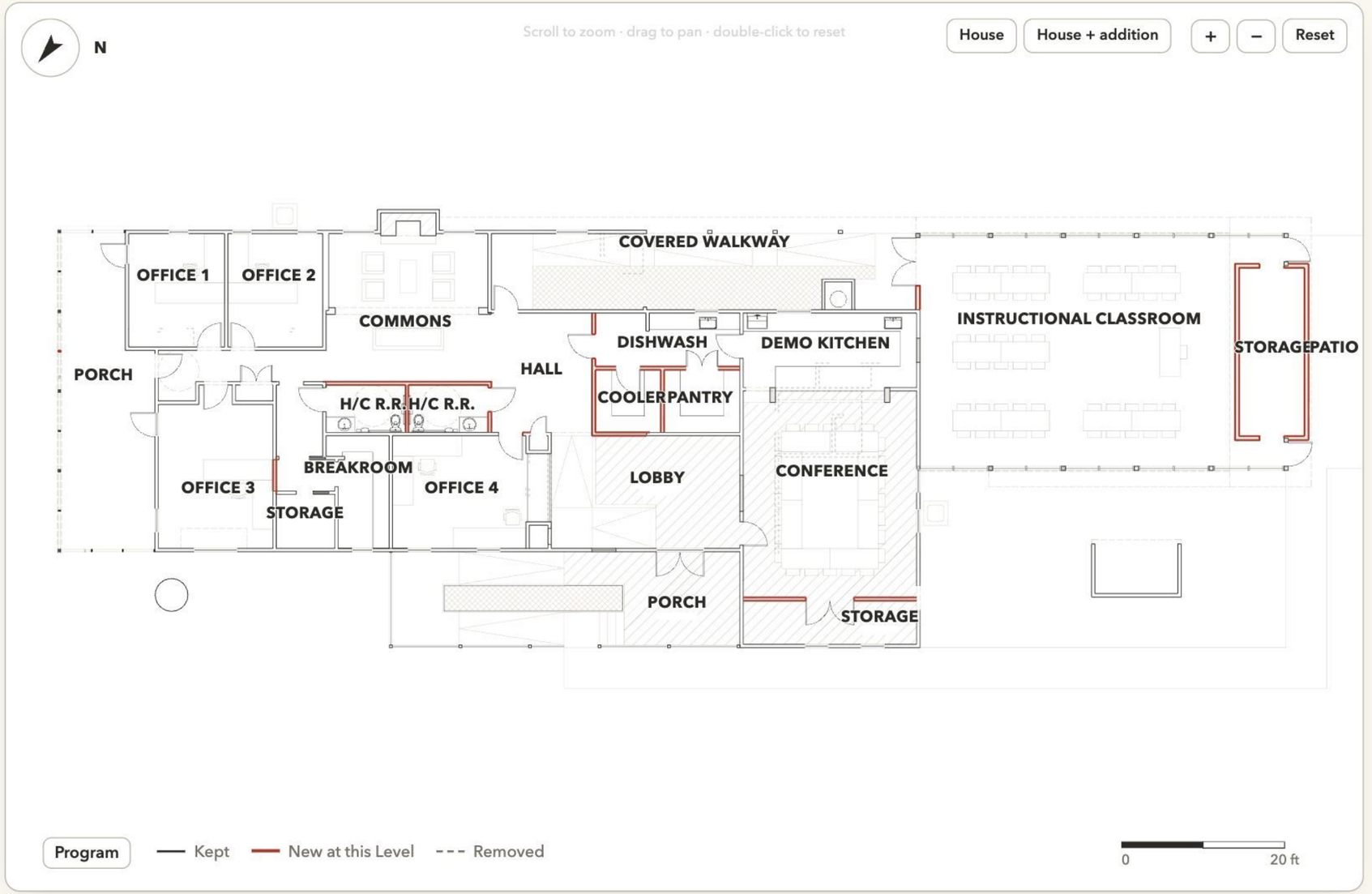
LEVEL 1 Lightest touch

LEVEL 2 Better management

LEVEL 3 Best case

Seibert Architects Red House study sheets A1.0 to A1.0-3 (3/16" = 1'-0"), aligned and compared wall by wall. Room sizes are from the sheets.

One house, three Levels of reuse



EXISTING The house today

LEVEL 1 Lightest touch

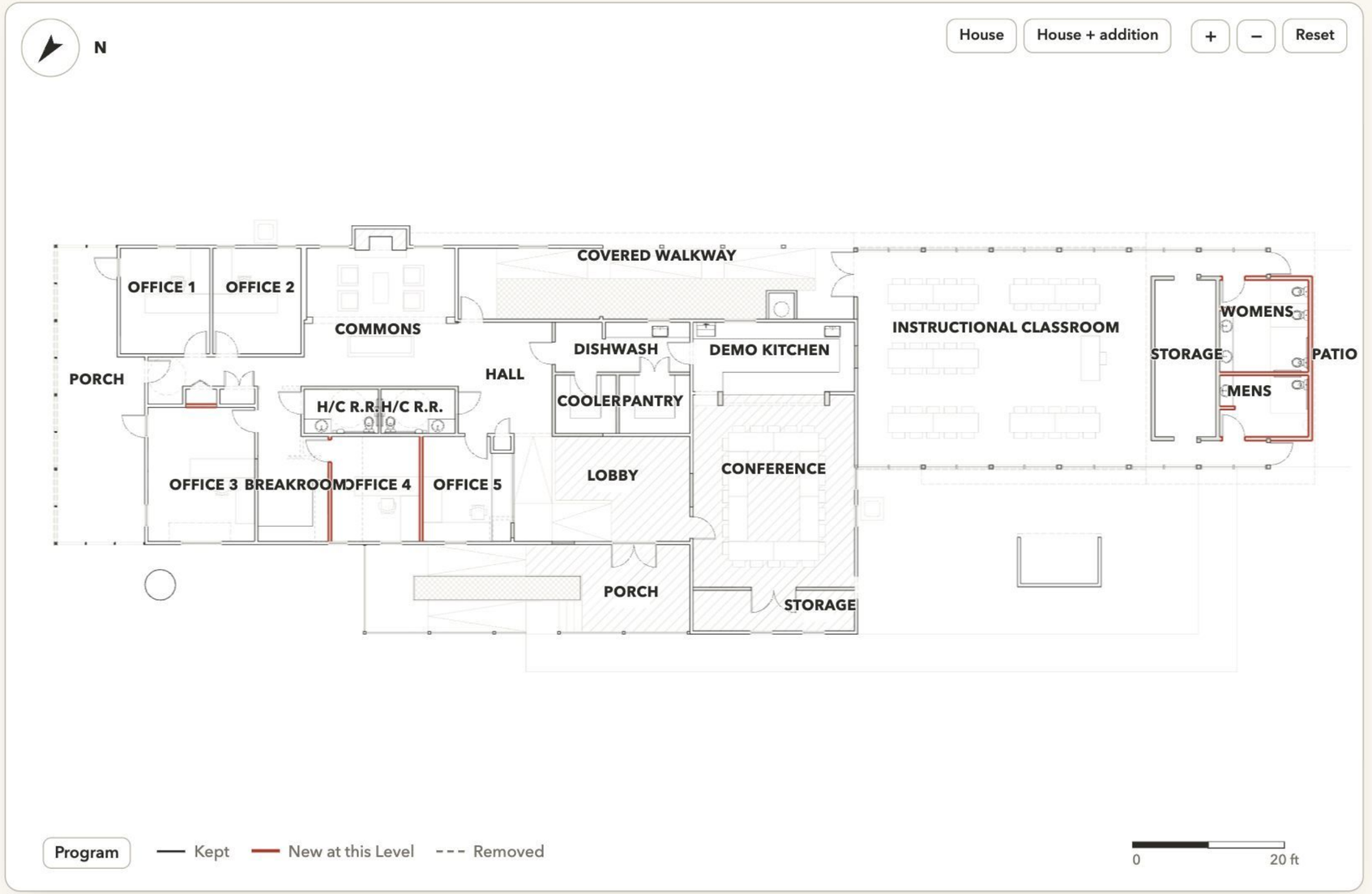
Opens up the plan: lobby, a 25' × 21' conference room for 20–25, a demo kitchen (dishwash, cooler, and pantry), four offices, commons, a breakroom, and two accessible restrooms. A 28' × 40' instructional classroom for about 50 goes under a new roof to the east, linked by a covered walkway.

LEVEL 2 Better management

LEVEL 3 Best case

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One house, three Levels of reuse



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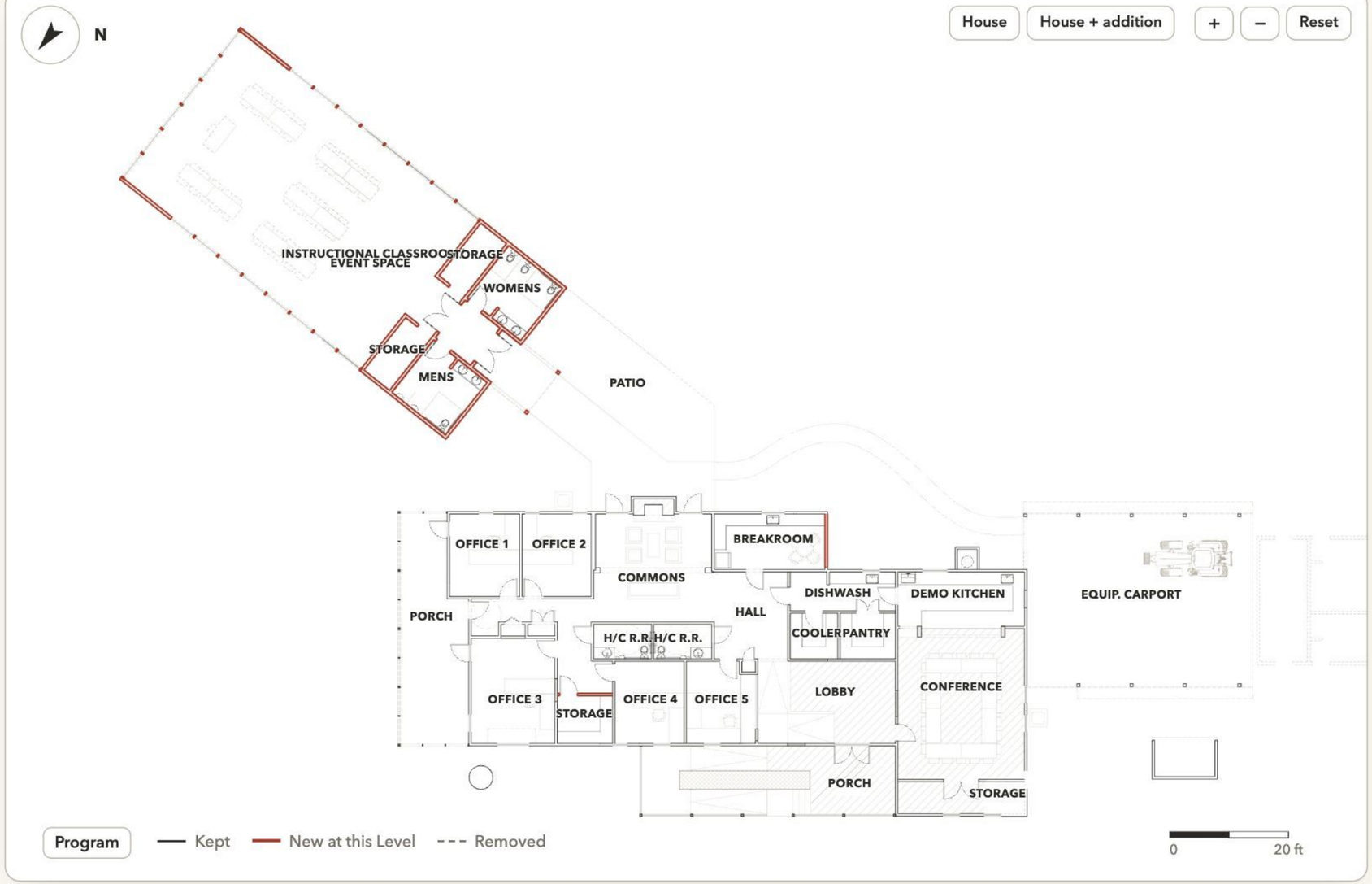
LEVEL 2 Better management

Adds Office 5 and separate men's and women's restrooms beside the classroom.

LEVEL 3 Best case

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One house, three Levels of reuse



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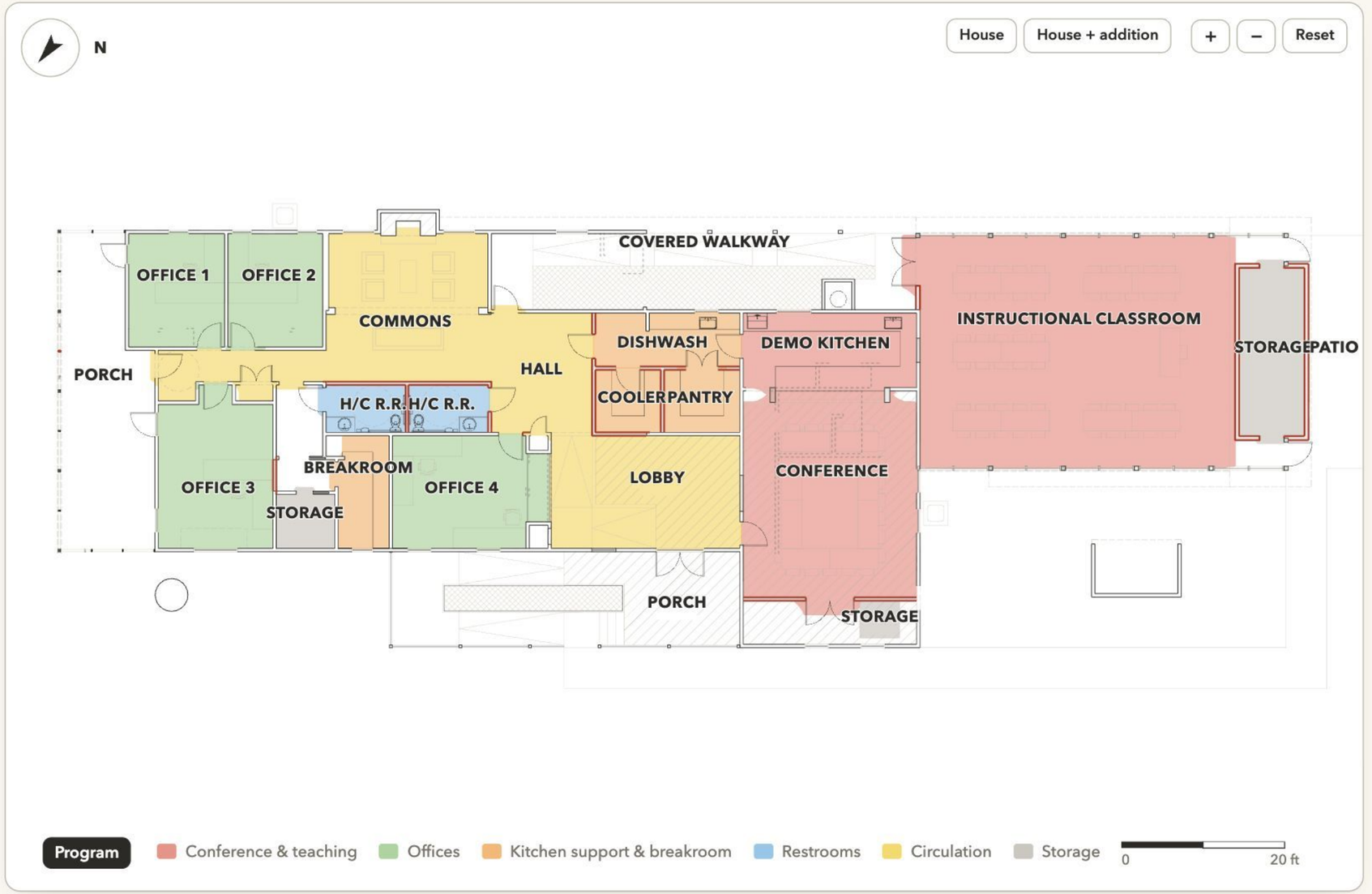
LEVEL 2 Better management

LEVEL 3 Best case

The classroom moves to a new 51' × 31' classroom and event building with its own restrooms and storage, set across a patio. The old classroom bay becomes a 28' × 36' equipment carport, and the breakroom moves beside the commons.

Seibert Architects Red House study sheets A1.0 to A1.0-3 (3/16" = 1'-0"), aligned and compared wall by wall. Room sizes are from the sheets.

One house, three Levels of reuse



EXISTING The house today

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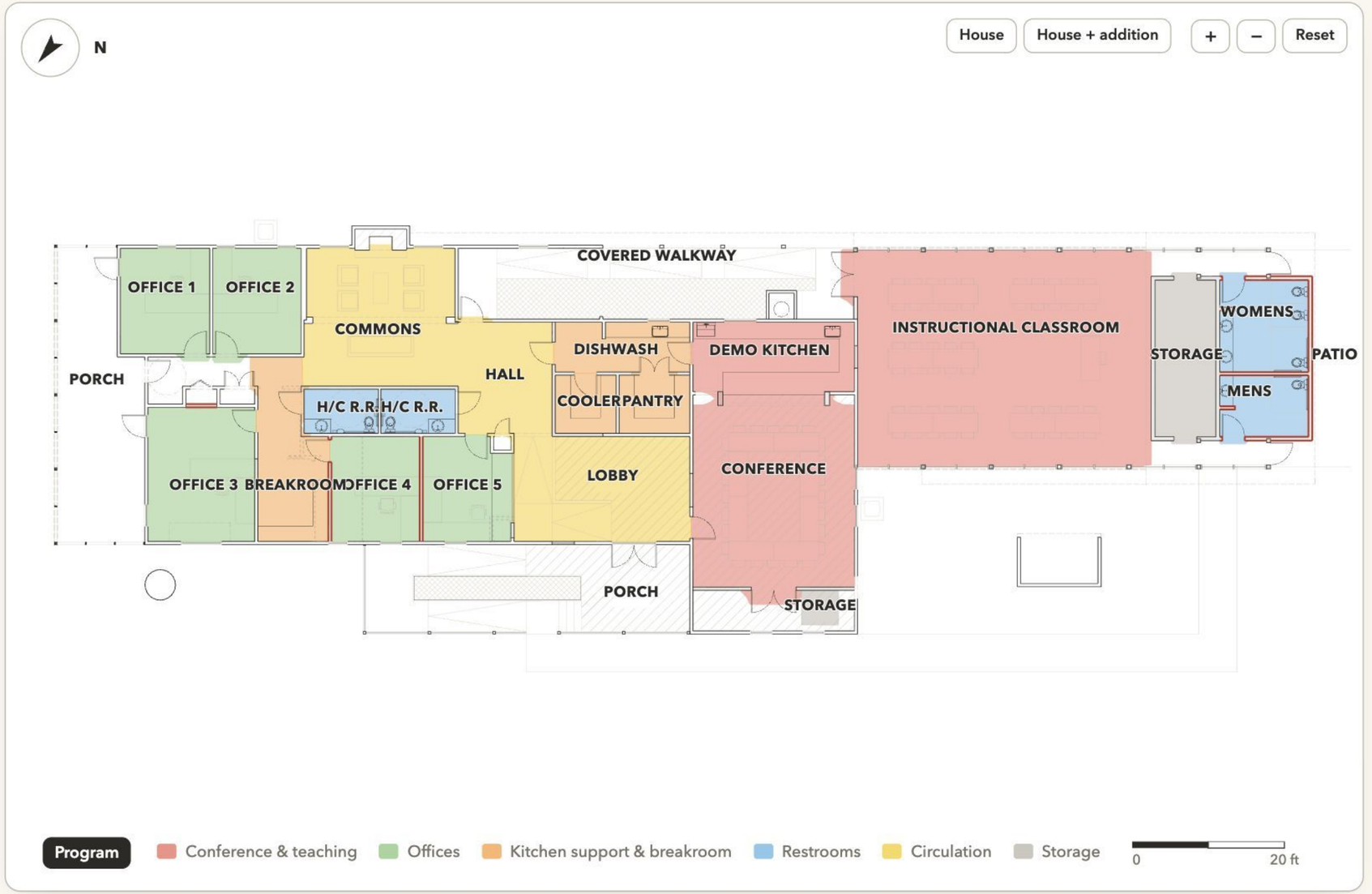
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OVER TO YOU

Where we'd value your input

Topics for the tables. Tell us where the plan is wrong, weak, or missing something.

Pasture and rotation

- Do the paddock sizes and gates support a workable rotation?
- Are the stocking rates right for this forage?
- What animal weights should set the head count?

Animals and operations

- What herd size makes the Beginning Rancher program work as a teaching operation?
- Our ag consultant recommends a manure spreader over more complex ways of recovering nutrients from waste. Does that suit this site?
- How should washdown water be handled?
- What have we left out of the barns and handling areas?

Water and wet ground

- Where should troughs and water lines go?
- How should grazing be timed on the wettest soils?
- Should cattle be fenced out of the slough, ponds, and wet edges, and how wide should that buffer be?
- How sacred is the historical slough bed that crosses the site? It conflicts with some of the program and complicates the civil design
- Which floodplain compensation option, and is more freeboard for the livestock buildings worth the cost?

Wooded pasture

- How should the oak hammock paddocks be grazed?
- Is there a case for improving forage under the pines and palms?
- Which trees matter most to protect?
- The water oaks along the entry drive are poorly suited to this ground and drop limbs on the drive. Is it OK to thin them?

Demonstration

- Which areas should be set aside for demonstration programs?
- What cutting-edge practices need a home on this site?